

INTERNAL ONLY

H O R I Z O N S

Attendee Directory

Attendee Directory

A

AGOSTINO SIMONETTA

GSC Game World

AKIN BABAYIGIT

Arcadia Gaming Partners

ALEX CAPRETTA

Haveli Investments

ALEXANDER EKVALL

Snowprint Studios

ALEXEY MIKHAYLOV

HypeTrain Digital

ALEXIS BONTE

Stillfront Group

ALICIA HUANG

Paper Games

ALISTAIR MCFARLANE

Facepunch Studios

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Burny Games

ANTHONY TIRONE

Tech Tree Games

ANTON ALBIIN

Perfect Random

ANTON VOLOVYK

Reface

ANTON WESTBERGH

Coffee Stain Group

ARMAGAN YAVUZ

TaleWorlds Entertainment

ARND BENNINGHOFF

MTG

ASBJOERN SOENDERGAARD

Tactile Games

ASH HABIB

Steel City Interactive

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BABAR AHMED

Mindstorm Studio

BADER ALZAMIL

Kammelna Gaming Group

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BAŞAK BÜKÜMCÜ

e2vc

BEN DRURY

Yoto

BEN LIU

Code Dish

BENOIT DUCREST

Million Victories

BERNARD KIM

Supercell and Unity

BRIAN LOVELL

Red Games Co.

C

CARL LIVIE

JustPlay

CAROLIN KRENZER

Trailmix

CHARLIE CHAPMAN

First Touch Games

CHEN LESHEZ

Playtika

CHRIS LEE

Cascade Interactive

CHRIS PETROVIC

FunPlus

CHRIS VAN DER KUYL

4J Studios

CHRISTIAN LÖVSTEDT

Midjiwan

CRAIG CHITTICK

Miniclip

CRISTOBAL VIEDMA

Lingokids

CYRIL CAEL

AppLovin

D

DANIEL NATHAN

HOMA

DAVE YONAMINE

MobilityWare

DIANA MOLDAVSKY

Tencent

DMITRI LIPNITSKY

Gismart

DU XUEQIAN

Hungry Studio

E

ECE BILGEHAN

Curve Animation

EMILIEN EYCHENNE

Adikteev

EMMANUEL DE MAISTRE

Scenario

EMRE ÇELİK

Loom Games

ERIK LEVIN DE VERDIER

TENSTACK

ERKAY UZUN

Unico Studio

F

FABIAN KAMBERI

Born

FATİH HALTAS

Ferah

FLORIAN SCHUHBAUER

Active Ownership

FLOYD HORNG

Uplift Games

FRANK SAGNIER

Everplay

FRANZISKA MEYER

Edurino

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GABRIEL GODARD

Tacty Studio

GEO MORGAN

CRITICAL REFLEX

GERARD GRIFFIN

Supercell

GRAEME STRUTHERS

Devolver Digital

GRANT SMITH

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HARVEY ELLIOTT

Playstack

HENRIC SUURONEN

Play Ventures

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ILKER ILICALI

Good Job Games

IRENE KLEMM

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JAN SOMMERFELD

Almedia

JANETTE D'ALESSIO

Plan A Games

JAY CHI

Makers Fund

JERRY YANG

Hungry Studio

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Ludia

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Jagex

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Cascade Interactive

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GamoVation

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JORDI DE LOS PINOS

Smadex

JOSE SIRERA

Uplift Games

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KATERINA DUDINSKAYA

Goodville

KELLY BIANUCCI

Atari

KIRSTEN-LEE NAIDOO

Evil Landfall?

KIRSTY RIGDEN

FuturLab

KRISTINE KAKUNO

Offworld Industries

KÜBRA GÜNDOĞAN

Loom Games

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LARS WINGEFORS

Embracer Group

LEE HUTCHINSON

Double Eleven

LI MA

Tencent Games

LIOR SHIFF

Tripledote Studios

LUISA BORDONARO

Milestone

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Global Sport Group

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MARCUS LIASSIDES

Mattel

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M

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Tencent

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MAXIME DEMEURE

Madbox

MAYA ROGERS

Tetris

MELISA YAGUBOGLU

Laton Ventures

MICHAEL BERKOVICH

Play Perfect

MICHAEL MARTINEZ

FunCraft

MICHAEL QIAN

Kairos Data

MICHAL NOWAKOWSKI

CD Projekt

MIKKEL WEIDER

Everplay

MICHAEL KATKOFF

Deconstructor of Fun

N

NACHUAN LI

Tencent Games

NATHAN JONES

Sony Interactive Entertainment

NATHAN SELLYN

Behaviour Interactive

NAZIM AKMANDIL

Good Job Games

NICK HOPKINS

MTG

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52 Entertainment

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Loom Games

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Fumb Games

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UVS Games

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AIBY

PHIL MOHR

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REBECCA LAUTNER

Landfall / Evil Landfall?

RÉMI RACINE

Behaviour Interactive

RIDZKI SYAHPUTERA

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Playtika

ROHIT SHARMA

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RUDI BONAPARTE

LEGO Digital Play

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SAAD CHOUDRI

Miniclip

SAAD HAMEED

Game District

SAI SRINIVAS

M League

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SAMI KHAN

Atlas Reality

SHLOMI AIZENBERG

Scopely

STEFAN VOGLER

CipSoft

STEPHAN ANSARI

Miniclip

STEPHAN BEINERT

JustPlay

T

TOBIAS SPRINGER

tobspr Games

TOM GUILLERMIN

Sandfall

TYNAN SYLVESTER

Ludeon Studios

U

ÜMIT BONCUKÇU

Magiclab & Rooftop Games

V

VALERY KURILOV

Hitapps

VICKIE CHEN

Aviagames

VINCENT NAIDEN

Vizor

VISHAL MAHTANI

Kashkick & Besitos

VISHNU VIJAYAKUMAR

TaleWorlds Entertainment

VLADIMIR OANE

Deepstash

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WILL PORTER

The Indie Stone

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XAVIER MARIANI

Adikteev

XIANG SHEN

Century Games

Y

YARON LEYVAND

Zynga

YİĞİT DORUK

TENSTACK

YUNING ZHANG

TPG / IMC

Z

ZAUR BEDOEV

Tripledote Studios

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H O R I Z O N S

PC / Console



Chris van der Kuyl

Chairman & Co-Founder, 4J

[LinkedIn](#)

Scottish digital entrepreneur who co-founded 4J Studios in 2005 and led its work porting Minecraft to consoles; also Principal at Chroma Ventures.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Independent video game developer (console ports & original sandbox / party titles)
- **Location:** Dundee, Scotland
- **Founded:** 2005 by Chris van der Kuyl / Paddy Burns
- **Headcount:** ~50 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held; independent, founder-owned
- **Description:** Best known for porting Minecraft to consoles; now building original titles on its Elements Engine

Flagship titles

Reforj

Launch: TBD

Genre: Open-world survival sandbox

Manic Mechanics

Launch: 2024

Genre: Chaotic couch co-op party

Recent news & activity

- Opened a second studio in Edinburgh (50+ staff across sites) to crew its first wholly owned IP.
- Debut original IP Reforj - a voxel open-world sandbox on its proprietary Elements Engine - entered public Xbox Insider pre-alpha, targeting a 2026 release.
- Pivoting from its Minecraft console-editions legacy to owned IP (Reforj announced Sept 2024).



Kelly Bianucci

[LinkedIn](#)

Chief Operating Officer, Atari

Operating leader with two decades across gaming, finance and technology, specializing in M&A, transformations and operational scale-ups. Served on Atari's board for ~6 years before becoming COO. MBA, Kellogg; BS, NYU Stern.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Interactive entertainment & IP licensing (classic & retro gaming)
- **Location:** New York, USA
- **Founded:** 1972; reorganized under CEO Wade Rosen
- **Headcount:** ~200
- **Ownership:** Publicly traded (Atari SA)
- **Description:** Original innovator of video gaming; 200+ franchises (Asteroids, Centipede, Pong)

Flagship titles

Atari 50

Launch: 2022

Genre: Anniversary game collection

RollerCoaster Tycoon

Launch: Franchise

Genre: Construction & management sim

Recent news & activity

- Agreed to acquire Crossy Road maker Hipster Whale (340M+ downloads) for an initial \$29.3M (up to \$39.3M with earn-outs); founder Matt Hall to lead Atari's mobile push (Jun 2026).
- Completed an aggressive IP roll-up: rights to the first five Wizardry RPGs (May 2026), emulation studio Implicit Conversions (Apr 2026), and a ~82% buyout/delisting of Sweden's Thunderful Group.
- Struck a strategic IP deal with Ubisoft to revive five titles (Cold Fear, I Am Alive, Child of Eden, Grow Home, Grow Up).
- Kelly Bianucci promoted from the board to COO, reporting to CEO Wade Rosen (Nov 2025).



Rémi Racine

[LinkedIn](#)

**Co-Founder, CEO & Executive Producer,
Behaviour**

Founder-CEO who built Behaviour into the largest Canadian game studio over 30+ years. Named a Goldman Sachs Most Exceptional Entrepreneur (2023) and former Chairman of CBC/Radio-Canada.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development & publishing (original IP + work-for-hire services)
- **Location:** Montreal, Canada (studios in Toronto, Seattle, UK & Netherlands)
- **Founded:** 1992 (Quebec City); led by Racine since the mid-1990s
- **Headcount:** ~1,300 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent (privately held)
- **Description:** Largest Canadian game company; creators of Dead by Daylight (50M+ players) with 70M+ games sold

Flagship titles

Dead by Daylight

Launch: 2016

Genre: Asymmetric
multiplayer horror

Meet Your Maker

Launch: 2023

Genre: Build-and-raid
action

Recent news & activity

- Acquired The Fun Pimps, creators of 7 Days to Die (20M+ sold), expanding its horror/survival portfolio beyond Dead by Daylight (Mar 2026).
- Earlier acquired Darkest Dungeon studio Red Hook Studios, part of a deliberate owned-IP build-out.
- Promoted Nathan Sellyn to Deputy CEO and Stephanie Marchand to COO (Jan 2026).



Nathan Sellyn

Deputy CEO, Behavior

[LinkedIn](#)

Architect of Behaviour's corporate strategy and senior link to its strategic and financial partners. Joined in 2022 as Chief of Staff and VP–Strategy; oversees corporate development, publishing, marketing and licensing. BA, Princeton.

Company Overview

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Flagship titles

Dead by Daylight

Launch: 2016

Genre: Asymmetric multiplayer horror

Meet Your Maker

Launch: 2023

Genre: Build-and-raid action

Recent news & activity

- Promoted to Deputy CEO, leading corporate strategy, M&A and publishing (Jan 2026).
- Acquired The Fun Pimps, creators of 7 Days to Die (20M+ sold), expanding its horror/survival portfolio beyond Dead by Daylight (Mar 2026).
- Earlier acquired Darkest Dungeon studio Red Hook Studios, part of a deliberate owned-IP build-out.



Jono Jones

Co-Founder, Cascade Interactive

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder of Cascade Interactive, an athlete-led extreme-sports games publisher. Works alongside brother Matt Jones (Red Bull MTB pro) to bring authentic rider-built experiences such as MAVRIX to market.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Athlete-led extreme-sports video games (publisher)
- **Location:** United Kingdom
- **Founded:** Co-founded by Jono & Matt Jones
- **Headcount:** Independent studio; co-develops with partner teams (~10)
- **Ownership:** Privately held; founder-owned
- **Description:** Pairs world-class athletes, brands & events with game-dev talent; debut title MAVRIX built with Third Kind Games

Flagship titles

MAVRIX (PC)

Launch: 2025

Genre: Open-world
MTB sports

MAVRIX (Console)

Launch: 2026

Genre: Open-world
MTB sports

Recent news & activity

- No funding round or M&A on record; appears founder-funded at this stage.
- Early-stage UK studio building MAVRIX, a AAA mountain-bike game, co-developed with Third Kind Games (Forza Horizon, Sea of Thieves veterans).
- Founder Jono Jones - a pro Red Bull Hardline MTB rider and ex-infrastructure-debt banker - left finance in early 2025 to run the studio full-time.



Michał Nowakowski

Joint CEO, CD Projekt

[LinkedIn](#)

Joint CEO of CD Projekt since 2024, leading business strategy, sales and the franchise flywheel. With the company since 2005 (previously COO), he steers partner and investor relations for one of Europe's biggest game makers

Company Overview

- **Genre:** AAA game development & publishing (story-driven open-world RPGs)
- **Location:** Warsaw, Poland
- **Founded:** 1994; CD Projekt RED studio established 2002
- **Headcount:** ~1,500 employees across multiple studios
- **Ownership:** Publicly traded (Warsaw Stock Exchange, WIG30)
- **Description:** Creators of The Witcher (85M+ copies) and Cyberpunk 2077 (35M+); building The Witcher 4 and new IP Hadar

Flagship titles

The Witcher 3: Wild Hunt

Launch: 2015

Genre: Open-world RPG

Cyberpunk 2077

Launch: 2020

Genre: Open-world action RPG

Recent news & activity

- Q1 2026 results: revenue PLN 191M (+6% YoY), net income PLN 106M; The Witcher series passed 85M copies and Cyberpunk 2077 35M (May 2026).
- The Witcher 4 (Project Polaris) is in full production with ~513 developers on UE5; launch reaffirmed as 2027 at the earliest.
- Cyberpunk sequel 'Project Orion' is the second-largest active project; team grown to ~149 devs (from 84 a year earlier).



Stephan Vogler

CEO & Co-Founder, CIPSOFT

[LinkedIn](#)

One of four founders who built Tibia as students and turned it into a 25+ year live MMORPG. Leads CipSoft's day-to-day business, partnerships and PR as part of its three-person management team

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Online game development & operation (live-service MMORPGs)
- **Location:** Regensburg, Germany
- **Founded:** 8 June 2001 (Tibia online since Jan 1997)
- **Headcount:** 100+ employees
- **Ownership:** Independent, founder-owned GmbH; profitable since founding
- **Description:** Maker of Tibia, one of the oldest MMORPGs (€250M+ revenue); 2022 German Computer Games Award Studio of the Year

Flagship titles

Tibia

Launch: 1997

Genre: 2D fantasy MMORPG

Persist Online

Launch: 2024

Genre: Old-school survival MMORPG

Recent news & activity

- Privately held and self-funded; no M&A or external funding.
- Reported a record €28.32M annual turnover for 2025 with its largest-ever headcount growth; maker of the long-running MMORPG Tibia.



Anton Westbergh

CEO & Co-Founder, Coffee Stain

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Coffee Stain in 2010 as a student and grew it into a leading Nordic studio and publisher. Now leads the independent Coffee Stain Group, steward of franchises including Satisfactory, Deep Rock Galactic and Valheim

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development & publishing (sandbox, simulation, co-op)
- **Location:** Skövde, Sweden
- **Founded:** 2010 by nine University of Skövde students
- **Headcount:** Multi-studio group across the Nordics (~200)
- **Ownership:** Independent, publicly traded (Coffee Stain Group, spun off 2025)
- **Description:** Best known for Goat Simulator and Satisfactory; publisher of Deep Rock Galactic, Valheim and more

Flagship titles

Satisfactory

Launch: 2024

Genre: First-person
factory-building sim

Goat Simulator

Launch: 2014

Genre: Comedy
sandbox

Recent news & activity

- Spun off from Embracer as a standalone Nasdaq First North-listed company (completed Dec 2025; ~250+ devs; Satisfactory, Valheim, Deep Rock Galactic, Goat Simulator).
- Satisfactory launched 1.0 (Sept 2024; 5.5M+ sold) and arrived on PS5/Xbox Series consoles in Nov 2025.
- Anton Westbergh confirmed as Group CEO and board member of the listed company.



Geo Morgan

[LinkedIn](#)

Business Development Director, Critical Reflex

Leads business development at Critical Reflex, sourcing and signing experimental indie titles and building publishing partnerships with developers across the global games scene

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game publisher (experimental, atmospheric, genre-bending titles)
- **Location:** Nicosia, Cyprus (fully remote, distributed team)
- **Founded:** 2020 by CEO Rita Lebedeva
- **Headcount:** Small, distributed publishing team (~20)
- **Ownership:** Independent
- **Description:** Champions 'creepy & surreal' indie games; runs the CR Channel horror sub-label; known for Mouthwashing and Buckshot Roulette

Flagship titles

Buckshot Roulette

Launch: 2024

Genre: First-person
tabletop horror

Mouthwashing

Launch: 2024

Genre: Psychological
horror

Recent news & activity

- Cyprus-based indie publisher (Mouthwashing, Buckshot Roulette, Arctic Eggs) held its first 'CRITICAL REFLEX TIME' showcase, featuring 12+ titles (Sept 2025).
- Released horror title No, I'm not a Human (dev Trioskaz) and TROLEU on Steam.



Ece Bilgehan

CEO & Co-Founder, Curve Animation

[LinkedIn](#)

3D artist turned studio leader who co-founded Curve Animation with Selçuk Yağcı. Led the team behind Liar's Bar, the first Turkish game to win a Steam Award. Bilkent University; summer course at Parsons School of Design

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Animation studio & game developer (animation for film/TV/digital + games)
- **Location:** Ankara, Türkiye
- **Founded:** Co-founded by Ece Bilgehan & Selçuk Yağcı
- **Headcount:** Small, art-led creative team (~10)
- **Ownership:** Independent, founder-owned
- **Description:** First Turkish team to win a Steam Award (Most Innovative Gameplay) for Liar's Bar, downloaded ~7M+ times

Flagship titles

Liar's Bar
Launch: 2024
Genre: Social-deduction party horror

Recent news & activity

- Ankara-based studio; breakout party game Liar's Bar launched in Early Access Oct 2024 and peaked at ~113,800 concurrent Steam players.
- Became the first Turkish team to win a Steam Award ('Most Innovative Gameplay,' for Liar's Bar).



Graeme Struthers

[LinkedIn](#)

COO & Co-Founder, Devolver

Co-founded Devolver Digital in 2009 after years at Gamecock, Virgin Interactive and EA. Became COO in 2022 to scale operations post-IPO, joined the Board in 2024, and is a major shareholder

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game publisher (premium third-party & own-IP titles)
- **Location:** Austin, Texas, USA
- **Founded:** June 2009 by five Gamecock / Gathering of Developers alumni
- **Headcount:** ~280 employees
- **Ownership:** Public (AIM: DEVO); founder-controlled, with NetEase, Sony & Kwalee minority stakes
- **Description:** Award-winning publisher of 100+ premium indie titles, known for its irreverent marketing

Flagship titles

Hotline Miami

Launch: 2012

Genre: Top-down
action

Cult of the Lamb

Launch: 2022

Genre: Roguelike
action

Recent news & activity

- FY2025 results: profit after tax \$69M (vs \$26M in 2024), +39% adjusted EBITDA, positive H2 free cash flow (Apr 2026).
- Most recent major M&A was acquiring Astroneer studio System Era Softworks (up to \$40M).
- Devolver Direct 2025 broke format to spotlight Ball x Pit via a mini-documentary; the slate also included Baby Steps and Possessor(s).



Lee Hutchinson

Founder, Double Eleven

[LinkedIn](#)

Ex-Rockstar Leeds lead programmer who co-founded Double Eleven in 2009 and grew it from his loft into a 340-person studio. Led it as CEO for 15+ years; now Chairman of parent Pneuma Group. NE Entrepreneur of the Year 2021

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development & publishing (co-development, ports, own IP)
- **Location:** Middlesbrough, North Yorkshire, UK (+ Kuala Lumpur)
- **Founded:** 23 December 2009 by Lee Hutchinson & Matt Shepcar
- **Headcount:** 350+ employees
- **Ownership:** Independent (owned by Pneuma Group)
- **Description:** Trusted co-dev & porting partner (Prison Architect, Fallout 76, Red Dead Redemption); now building original IP

Flagship titles

Prison Architect

Launch: 2019

Genre: Construction
& management sim

Red Dead Redemption

Launch: 2024

Genre: Action
Adventure

Recent news & activity

- Exited the Prison Architect franchise after ~9 years when Paradox handed the sequel to another studio.
- Appointed co-CEOs Kimberley Turner and Mark South (Oct 2025); founder Lee Hutchinson moved to Chairman of parent company Pneuma Group.



Gabriel Godard

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO & Game Director, Tacty Studio

French developer (known online as 'Amnedge') who founded Tacty Studio and serves as CEO and Game Director on Drive Beyond Horizons, the studio's debut open-world driving sandbox

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (open-world driving / survival sandbox)
- **Location:** Saint-Jory, France
- **Founded:** 2025 (SAS) by Gabriel Godard
- **Headcount:** ~20 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent (privately held)
- **Description:** Young French studio behind Drive Beyond Horizons, built in Unreal Engine 5 and published with Santor Games

Flagship titles

Drive Beyond Horizons

Launch: 2025

Genre: Open-world driving survival

Passed Out

Launch: 2023

Genre: Battle Royale

Recent news & activity

- Community-funded via Patreon/Boosty, with no external publishing deal disclosed.
- Open-world driving-survival sandbox Drive Beyond Horizons (UE5, 4-player co-op) launched in Steam Early Access Mar 2025; the team expects 2–3 years in EA.
- Developed by Tacty Studio and published by Santor Games.



Frank Sagnier

[LinkedIn](#)

Non-Executive Chairman, Everplay

Veteran games-industry leader and former Codemasters CEO. Chairs the Everplay Group board, stepping in as Interim Executive Chair through 2025 before reverting to Non-Executive Chairman as the new CEO took over

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development & publishing (multi-label group)
- **Location:** Nottingham/Wakefield, UK (8 locations across 5 countries)
- **Founded:** 1990 (as Team17); listed 2018; rebranded Everplay in 2025
- **Headcount:** 400+ employees
- **Ownership:** Public (LON: EVPL)
- **Description:** Three divisions - Team17, astragon & StoryToys - and 150+ games incl. Worms, Overcooked! and Hell Let Loose

Flagship titles

Overcooked!

Launch: 2016

Genre: Co-op cooking chaos

Worms

Launch: 1995

Genre: Turn-based artillery

Recent news & activity

- Rebranded from Team17 Group to everplay group plc (ticker EVPL) in Jan 2025.
- Acquired the Hammerwatch franchise from Crackshell (~£8M / \$10.9M) and, via a consortium, Bulkhead from Tencent; also took a 20% stake in Super Media Group.
- FY2025: revenue flat at £166M; adjusted EBITDA +11% to £48.5M; Team17 sales hit a record £106M.
- Frank Sagnier (ex-Codemasters) moved from Interim Exec Chair to Non-Exec Chair.



Mikkel Weider

Group CEO, Everplay

[LinkedIn](#)

Gaming and M&A leader who founded Nordisk Games in 2016 and scaled it from zero to 1,300+ staff, acquiring Avalanche and Supermassive. Becomes Everplay Group CEO on 1 January 2026

Company Overview

- Genre:** Indie game development & publishing (multi-label group)
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- Acquired the Hammerwatch franchise (~£8M) and Bulkhead from Tencent; took a 20% stake in Super Media Group.
- Mikkel Weider (ex-Nordisk Games) became Group CEO effective Jan 2026.



Kirsten-Lee Naidoo

CEO, Evil Landfall?

[LinkedIn](#)

Leads Landfall's publishing label Evil Landfall and serves as Head of Publishing at Landfall. Sits on the WINGS fund Selection Committee; previously Head of Account Management at indie consultancy Robot Teddy

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game publishing & investment (Landfall's label)
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- **Founded:** ~2023 internally; publicly launched April 2026
- **Headcount:** Seven-person team
- **Ownership:** Part of independent studio Landfall Games
- **Description:** Hands-off backer of silly, physics-based co-op games; invests up to ~\$1M a year without taking IP

Flagship titles

Peak

Launch: 2025

Genre: Co-op climbing

Content Warning

Launch: 2024

Genre: Co-op horror

Recent news & activity

- Unveiled Evil Landfall, Landfall's Stockholm publishing label offering up to \$1M per game to a few indie titles a year, with developers keeping full IP and a ban on AI-generated pitches (Apr 2026).
- Portfolio includes viral hit REPO and upcoming 2026 co-op sim How To Fish.



Alistair McFarlane

COO & Director, Facepunch

[LinkedIn](#)

COO and company director at Facepunch and the public face of Rust. Known for a community-first approach - active on the Rust subreddit - and for a headline-grabbing offer to buy New World to keep it alive

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (survival, sandbox & creation tools)
- **Location:** United Kingdom
- **Founded:** 2004 by Garry Newman (of Garry's Mod fame)
- **Headcount:** ~145 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent, founder-owned
- **Description:** Maker of Rust and Garry's Mod; now building the s&box platform and Rust Mobile

Flagship titles

Rust
Launch: 2013
Genre: Multiplayer survival

Garry's Mod
Launch: 2006
Genre: Sandbox

Recent news & activity

- s&box (the Source 2 successor to Garry's Mod) reached full release at \$19.99 (Apr 2026).
- Signed a Valve deal letting creators export s&box games as standalone Steam titles for free; the engine went open source with a \$1M/year creator fund.
- Rust continues monthly content patches in its 12th year.



Grant Smith

Chief Business Officer, Facepunch

[LinkedIn](#)

Chief Business Officer at Facepunch, leading the commercial side of the studio behind Rust and Garry's Mod - partnerships, business development and platform strategy across its live games and new projects.

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Kirsty Rigden

CEO, FuturLab

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO of FuturLab and the originator of PowerWash Simulator. Known for a people-first leadership style that prioritizes job security, she steered the studio through its 2024 acquisition by Miniclip

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development (simulation, action, casual)
- **Location:** Brighton, England, UK
- **Founded:** 2003
- **Headcount:** Mid-size indie studio (~100)
- **Ownership:** Owned by Miniclip (acquired 2024); operates independently
- **Description:** Creators of the global hit PowerWash Simulator and the Velocity series

Flagship titles

PowerWash Simulator

Launch: 2022

Genre: Simulation

Velocity 2X

Launch: 2014

Genre: Action / shoot-'em-up

Recent news & activity

- Acquired by Swiss publisher Miniclip (giving Miniclip a PC/console foothold); Rigden stays as CEO with creative independence.
- PowerWash Simulator 2 launched Oct 2025 (PC, Xbox Series, PS5, Switch 2), adding couch and online co-op; an Adventure Time DLC pack is set for Spring 2026.



Agostino Simonetta

[LinkedIn](#)

Chief Commercial Officer, Game World

Games-industry veteran of 25+ years who leads publishing and business development at GSC. Previously held senior roles at SEGA, THQ, Thunderful, ID@Xbox and PlayStation Europe

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (open-world FPS & real-time strategy)
- **Location:** Kyiv, Ukraine (second office in Prague since 2022)
- **Founded:** 1995
- **Headcount:** ~400 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent
- **Description:** Ukrainian studio behind the S.T.A.L.K.E.R. and Cossacks franchises; launched S.T.A.L.K.E.R. 2 in 2024

Flagship titles

S.T.A.L.K.E.R. 2

Launch: 2024

Genre: Open-world
FPS

Cossacks

Launch: 2001

Genre: Real-time
strategy

Recent news & activity

- S.T.A.L.K.E.R. 2: Heart of Chornobyl launched Nov 2024 (day-one Game Pass): 1M copies in ~36 hours, 6M+ players by Mar 2025.
- Sustained free updates through 2025–26 ahead of first paid DLC 'Cost of Hope,' with a major UE5 engine upgrade teased for 2026.



Lars Wingefors

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & Chair of the Board, Embracer

Swedish entrepreneur who founded Nordic Games (now Embracer Group) in 2011 and grew it into one of the world's largest gaming groups through 100+ acquisitions including THQ Nordic, Saber, Gearbox and Asmodee.

Company Overview

- **Sector:** Diversified gaming & entertainment (PC, console, mobile, tabletop)
- **HQ:** Karlstad, Sweden (listed on Nasdaq Stockholm)
- **Founded:** 2011 (originally Nordic Games, rebranded 2019)
- **Headcount:** ~6,000 across operating groups post-restructuring
- **Ownership:** Publicly listed; Lars Wingefors AB largest shareholder
- **Description:** Global gaming & entertainment group built via 100+ acquisitions; reorganised in 2024 into three units (Coffee Stain, Asmodee spin-off, Fellowship Entertainment)

Flagship titles

Kingdom Come:

Deliverance

Launch: 2018

Genre: Open-world
RPG (Warhorse
Studios)

Reanimal

Launch: 2026

Genre: Horror

Recent news & activity

- Completed strategic split of Embracer into three independent entities (2024–25): Coffee Stain & Friends, Asmodee (spun off 2025) and Fellowship Entertainment
- Transitioned from Group CEO to Chair of the Board in 2025 to focus on long-term strategy and capital allocation
- Oversaw the 2024 restructuring program — studio divestitures, headcount reductions and deleveraging to stabilise the balance sheet
- Continues to be the group's largest shareholder through Lars Wingefors AB



Alexey Mikhaylov

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & COO, HypeTrain Digital

Co-founder and operating lead of HypeTrain Digital, an indie video-game publisher and developer working with talented studios worldwide to bring unique PC and console games to market.

Company Overview

- **Sector:** Indie video-game publishing & development (PC and console)
- **HQ:** Nicosia, Cyprus
- **Founded:** 2016
- **Headcount:** ~11–50 employees (small, globally distributed team)
- **Ownership:** Independent; privately held
- **Description:** Indie publisher partnering with developers worldwide; portfolio includes Voidtrain, Breathedge, Stoneshard, Pathologic 3, Black Book, Tunche and The Wild Eight

Flagship titles

Voidtrain

Launch: 2025

Genre: FPS survival
(in-house)

Pathologic 3

Launch: 2026

Genre: Survival horror
(Ice-Pick Lodge)

Recent news & activity

- HypeMasters (Abu Dhabi; WWII RTS World War Armies, 7M+ players) raised a \$1M seed led by Saudi Arabia's Impact46 to fund Middle East expansion and new strategy titles (Dec 2025).



Marcus Bromander

[LinkedIn](#)

COO & Co-Founder, Innersloth

Co-founder of Innersloth and co-creator of Among Us (online as 'PuffballsUnited'). A designer and artist who also made the Henry Stickmin series, he conceived the social-deduction concept that became a global phenomenon.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development & publishing (social deduction, comedy)
- **Location:** Redmond, Washington, USA (remote-first)
- **Founded:** 2015 by Marcus Bromander & Forest Willard
- **Headcount:** Small indie team (~10-20)
- **Ownership:** Independent (LLC)
- **Description:** Creators of Among Us and The Henry Stickmin Collection; launched the Outersloth indie fund in 2024

Flagship titles

Among Us
Launch: 2018
Genre: Social deduction

Recent news & activity

- Its indie-funding label Outersloth has invested nearly \$20M across ~24 games on a recoup-then-revenue-share model.
- The Among Us animated series (with Titmouse) remains in development; the 2026 roadmap adds new roles and 'broader Innersloth universe' plans.
- Ongoing crossovers: Genshin Impact, Stardew Valley, Ace Attorney, and an announced Like a Dragon Cosmicube.



Jonathan Bellamy

Chief Executive Officer, Jagex

[LinkedIn](#)

Gaming executive and investor who became Jagex CEO in 2025. Brings M&A, venture and strategy experience (prior roles at Jagex and as CCO of Huuuge Games) plus 20+ years as a RuneScape player.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** MMORPG & live-service 'forever games'
- **Location:** Cambridge, England, UK
- **Founded:** 2001
- **Headcount:** ~500
- **Ownership:** Owned by CVC Capital Partners & Haveli Investments
- **Description:** Developer of the RuneScape franchise — 300M+ accounts and \$2B+ lifetime revenue

Flagship titles

Old School
RuneScape
Launch: 2013
Genre: MMORPG

RuneScape:
Dragonwilds
Launch: 2025
Genre: Survival

Recent news & activity

- The RuneScape studio was acquired by CVC Capital Partners with Haveli Investments in a deal valued at ~\$1.1B (Feb 2024).
- RuneScape: Dragonwilds (UE5 co-op survival) launched in Steam Early Access Apr 2025, with a full launch targeted for 2026.
- Jon Bellamy appointed CEO in March 2025, succeeding Phil Mansell; a 20-year RuneScape player and ex-Huuuge Games exec.



Maria Park

[LinkedIn](#)

VP & Head of Corporate Development, Krafton

Leads Krafton's corporate development, investments and M&A, having previously headed strategy at PUBG Corporation. Earlier roles include strategy lead at Riot Games and consultant at BCG. BA, University of Chicago; MBA, MIT Sloan.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development & publishing (battle royale, survival, action)
- **Location:** Seoul, South Korea
- **Founded:** 2018 (from Bluehole, after PUBG's success)
- **Headcount:** Global publisher with 10+ studios (~2,000)
- **Ownership:** Public (KRX: 259960); IPO 2021
- **Description:** Maker of PUBG: Battlegrounds; owns studios including Unknown Worlds (Subnautica) and Striking Distance

Flagship titles

PUBG:

Battlegrounds

Launch: 2017

Genre: Battle royale

Subnautica

Launch: 2018

Genre: Underwater survival

Recent news & activity

- FY2025 record results: revenue KRW 3.33T (>\$2B, +22.8% YoY) - its first year above KRW 3T; PUBG PC hit its highest-ever annual revenue (Feb 2026).
- Highly acquisitive: rescued Tango Gameworks (Hi-Fi Rush) from Microsoft, bought Eleventh Hour Games (Last Epoch, \$96M) and Nautilus Mobile, and agreed to acquire MENA publisher Tamatem.
- Life-sim inZOI launched in Steam Early Access Mar 2025, topping 1M sales in week one.
- Embroiled in the Subnautica 2 / Unknown Worlds lawsuit: a judge ordered the fired CEO reinstated and extended a \$250M earnout window.



Rebecca Lautner

[LinkedIn](#)

Chief Business Officer, Landfall Games

Leads brand development, business growth, partnerships and platform relations at Landfall and its Evil Landfall label. Before games, she ran an EU-funded initiative building cross-border industry networks from Berlin.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development & publishing (physics-based co-op & sandbox)
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- **Founded:** 2014
- **Headcount:** Small indie team (~30)
- **Ownership:** Independent; operates the Evil Landfall publishing label
- **Description:** Creators of Totally Accurate Battle Simulator, Content Warning and the breakout hit PEAK; known for shadow-drop launches

Flagship titles

PEAK

Launch: 2025

Genre: Co-op climbing

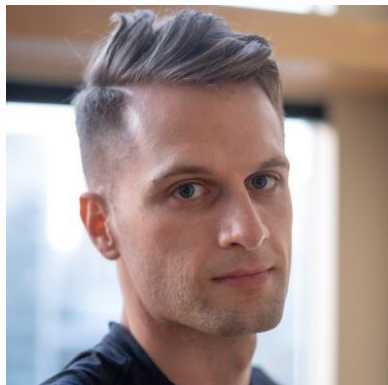
Totally Accurate Battle Simulator

Launch: 2021

Genre: Physics
sandbox

Recent news & activity

- Launched the Evil Landfall indie-publishing label, offering up to \$1M per game (Apr 2026).
- Co-developed and published co-op climbing hit PEAK (with Aggro Crab), launched June 2025 — 10M+ copies within ~two months, built for under ~\$200k.
- Surprise-launched the lightspeed roguelike Haste; brought Content Warning and Haste to PS5, Xbox and Switch/Switch 2.



Tynan Sylvester

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO, Ludeon Studios

Creator of RimWorld and founder of Ludeon Studios, which he started solo in 2013 with no outside funding. Former designer at Irrational Games (BioShock Infinite) and author of the book Designing Games.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (colony sim & story generators)
- **Location:** Canada (remote, global team)
- **Founded:** 2013 by Tynan Sylvester
- **Headcount:** Small independent team (~30)
- **Ownership:** Independent, founder-owned
- **Description:** Maker of RimWorld, one of the best-selling indie games ever (4M+ copies) with five major expansions

Flagship titles

RimWorld

Launch: 2018

Genre: Sci-fi colony
sim

RimWorld - Odyssey

Launch: 2025

Genre: Expansion

Recent news & activity

- No new (non-RimWorld) game announced; the studio remains small and independent.
- Shipped RimWorld – Odyssey (5th expansion) in July 2025 alongside the free 1.6 update, adding buildable 'gravships,' new biomes and 40+ animals.



Christian Lövestedt

CEO, Midjiwan

[LinkedIn](#)

Joined Midjiwan in 2018 and became CEO in 2019, overseeing management, marketing and development of The Battle of Polytopia. A vocal advocate for minimalist design and for taking mobile games seriously. M.Sc. Economics, Stockholm University.

Company Overview

- Genre:** Indie game development (4X / turn-based strategy)
- Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- Founded:** Polytopia released 2016; studio built around it by Felix Ekenstam
- Headcount:** Small specialist team (~15)
- Ownership:** Independent
- Description:** Creators of The Battle of Polytopia, a minimalist mobile-first 4X strategy hit with 20M+ downloads

Flagship titles

- The Battle of Polytopia

Launch: 2016

Genre: Mobile-first 4X strategy
- Polytopia: Path of the Ocean

Launch: 2024

Genre: Naval strategy update

Recent news & activity

- The Battle of Polytopia surpassed 25M organic mobile downloads (Feb 2026).
- For its 10-year anniversary, confirmed a new gameplay mode plus a physical card game for 2026.
- Launched a Polytopia Global World Championships esports event (\$10k prize pool).



Luisa Bordonaro

CEO, Milestone

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO of Milestone, the Milan studio she helped grow into the world's leading racing-game developer. Steered its 2019 acquisition by Koch Media / Plaion and serves as vice chair of Italy's IIDEA. Economics degree, Bocconi.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (racing & motorcycle racing simulations)
- **Location:** Milan, Italy
- **Founded:** 1996 (as Graffiti, 1994)
- **Headcount:** ~340 employees; largest Italian games studio
- **Ownership:** Part of Plaion (Embracer Group); acquired 2019
- **Description:** World-leading racing developer behind official MotoGP, MXGP, the RIDE series and Hot Wheels Unleashed

Flagship titles

RIDE

Launch: 2015

Genre: Motorcycle racing sim

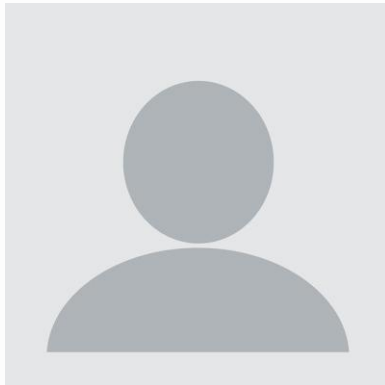
Hot Wheels Unleashed

Launch: 2021

Genre: Arcade racing

Recent news & activity

- Owned by PLAION, an Embracer Group company; ~290+ staff.
- Shipped MotoGP 25 (Apr 2025) and MotoGP 26 (revealed Mar 2026, launched Apr 2026 on PS5, Xbox Series, Switch 2, PC), adding rider-based handling and dynamic Rider Ratings.
- Also revealed RIDE 6.



Rohun Ranjith

CEO, Freelives

[LinkedIn](#)

Game developer at Free Lives, previously a UX Designer at Isazi Consulting. Holds a BA from the University of the Witwatersrand. A multi-SA Game Jam award-winning developer and credited on titles including Stick It to the Stick Man. Based in Cape Town.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development
- **Location:** Cape Town, South Africa
- **Founded:** 2011
- **Headcount:** ~10 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent (private)
- **Description:** Indie studio known for creative, physics-driven gameplay experiences

Flagship titles

Broforce

Launch: 2015

Genre: Action /
Adventure

Gorn

Launch: 2018

Genre: VR / Action

Recent news & activity

- Unconfirmed: no verifiable games studio, publisher, or label by this name surfaced.
- The matching individual is Rohun Ranjith, a Cape Town game designer/illustrator who has worked with Free Lives (Anger Foot, Broforce).



Kristine Kakuno

[LinkedIn](#)

VP of Finance, Offworld Industries

Leads finance at Offworld Industries, the studio behind the military FPS Squad. A CPA and CMA with finance leadership across software, gaming, retail and consulting; previously at Relic Entertainment. Based in Vancouver.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development & publishing (multiplayer military FPS)
- **Location:** New Westminister / Vancouver, Canada
- **Founded:** 2014 by Project Reality (Battlefield 2) modders
- **Headcount:** ~130 employees
- **Ownership:** Independent; minority investment from Tencent (2022)
- **Description:** Developer of the hit FPS Squad (2M+ sold) and publisher of Post Scriptum & Beyond the Wire

Flagship titles

Squad

Launch: 2020

Genre: Military FPS

Beyond the Wire

Launch: 2020

Genre: WWI FPS

Recent news & activity

- Squad Update 10.x added an Armed Forces of Ukraine faction (Nov 2025) and moved to UE5.7; the game has passed 6M+ copies.
- Shipped Starship Troopers: Extermination 1.0 (Oct 2024, with a Casper Van Dien-voiced campaign) and continues live-service updates into 2026.



Anton Albiin

CEO & Co-Founder, Perfect Random

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Perfect Random and leads its strategy, business, marketing and community — the studio behind FPS roguelike SULFUR. A 10+ year industry veteran and long-time Indie Ambassador for the Association of Swedish Game Developers.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Indie game development (FPS roguelike / action)
- **Location:** Sweden (remote — Stockholm, Malmö, Bodafors)
- **Founded:** 2021 by four co-founders
- **Headcount:** Small indie team
- **Ownership:** Independent; backed in part by Landfall Games
- **Description:** Creators of SULFUR, a gritty FPS roguelike that sold 300K+ copies in Early Access

Flagship titles

SULFUR

Launch: 2024

Genre: FPS roguelike

Perfect Random

Originals

Launch: Upcoming

Genre: Experimental indie games

Recent news & activity

- Small Stockholm studio; no external funding on record. CEO Anton Albiin is ex-Mojang.
- Debut FPS roguelite SULFUR launched in Steam Early Access Oct 2024, selling 300k+ copies during Early Access.
- A SULFUR PS5 demo dropped Sept 2025, with a console launch planned around the 1.0 milestone.



Harvey Elliott

Founder & CEO, Playstack

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder and CEO of indie publisher Playstack, known for a sharp eye for breakout hits — famously discovering Balatro by checking new Steam releases daily. Led the studio through its 2026 sale to Integrated Media Company.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Independent game publishing (premium indie titles)
- **Location:** London, United Kingdom
- **Founded:** 2014
- **Headcount:** ~ 70 employees
- **Ownership:** Being acquired by Integrated Media Company (2026); ~85% hit ratio
- **Description:** Publisher of Balatro, The Case of the Golden Idol, Mortal Shell & Abiotic Factor; \$100M+ Steam gross last year

Flagship titles

Balatro

Launch: 2024

Genre: Roguelike
deckbuilder

The Case of the Golden Idol

Launch: 2022

Genre: Detective
puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Owner TruFin agreed to sell its ~84.5% stake to VantageCo (a subsidiary of Integrated Media Company / IMC) at a ~£112M / ~\$151M valuation (May 2026).
- Breakout publish Balatro (dev LocalThunk) swept The Game Awards 2024 (Best Mobile, Best Debut Indie, Best Independent Game).
- Reports an 85%+ 'hit ratio,' \$100M+ gross on Steam and 20M+ downloads in the last financial year.



Tom Guillermín

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CTO, Sandfall Interactive

Co-founded Sandfall in 2020 with fellow ex-Ubisoft developers and serves as CTO and lead programmer. Built Clair Obscur: Expedition 33's gameplay almost entirely in Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints, empowering a tiny team to ship a Game of the Year.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (story-driven turn-based RPGs)
- **Location:** Montpellier, France
- **Founded:** 2020
- **Headcount:** ~40 developers (small core team)
- **Ownership:** Independent; published by Kepler Interactive
- **Description:** Debut studio behind Clair Obscur: Expedition 33 — 2025 Game of the Year, 8M+ units, most-awarded game in Game Awards history

Flagship titles

Clair Obscur:
Expedition 33
Launch: 2025
Genre: Turn-based
RPG

Recent news & activity

- Clair Obscur: Expedition 33 (published by Kepler Interactive) launched Apr 2025 and hit 8M units by Apr 2026 — built by ~33 people on a sub-\$10M budget.
- Became the most-awarded game in The Game Awards history (Game of the Year 2025 plus four more), then swept the Golden Joysticks and won 5 D.I.C.E. Awards.
- Has begun its next title and plans Clair Obscur as an anthology franchise — while deliberately staying a small team.



Ash Habib

Founder & CEO, Steel City

[LinkedIn](#)

Founded Steel City Interactive in 2020 with his brothers Asif and Asad to make the first major boxing game in over a decade. Left a corporate career with no games experience; now leads a 100+ person studio behind Undisputed

Company Overview

- Genre:** Game development (sports / combat sports simulation)
- Location:** Sheffield, England, UK
- Founded:** 2020 by Ash, Asif & Asad Habib
- Headcount:** ~100 employees
- Ownership:** Independent studio (Undisputed published by Deep Silver / Plaion)
- Description:** Maker of Undisputed, the first major boxing game in over a decade; now building Undisputed 2

Flagship titles

Undisputed
Launch: 2024
Genre: Boxing simulation

Undisputed 2
Launch: In development
Genre: Boxing simulation

Recent news & activity

- Undisputed surpassed 1 million copies sold across PC and consoles
- Confirmed Undisputed 2 in development, rebuilt from the ground up in Unreal Engine
- Recruited senior leaders from EA Sports, Codemasters, Rockstar and 2K
- Partnered with the WBC on an Undisputed esports programme



Alexis Bonte

[LinkedIn](#)

President & Group CEO, Stillfront

President & Group CEO of Stillfront (permanent appointment Mar 2025, after serving as interim CEO from Oct 2024 and Group COO from 2019). A free-to-play pioneer who co-founded eRepublik Labs in 2007.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile/browser games group - strategy, simulation, RPG, casual (federation of studios)
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- **Founded:** 2010 (IPO Dec 2015)
- **Headcount:** ~1,200 employees
- **Ownership:** Publicly listed (STO: SF / SF.ST); market cap ~2.54B SEK (InvestGame, 2026-06-04)
- **Description:** Publicly listed Swedish games group operating a federation of subsidiary studios across Europe, North America, the UK and MENA.

Flagship titles

BitLife - Life Simulator

Launch: 2018
(Candywriter)

Genre: Life simulation

Albion Online - Sandbox MMORPG

Launch: 2017 (PC),
mobile 2021

Genre: Sandbox
MMORPG

Recent news & activity

- Gameberry (Jun 3, 2026): subsidiary Moonfrog received a one-time \$26.5M (~SEK 245M) from Gameberry to settle its remaining payment obligations early (Ludo + ancillary titles, otherwise running to 2030) - cash in, not an acquisition
- Divested OFM Studios to its founder via management buyout for €2.1M (~SEK 23M), closed May 2026
- Mar 4, 2025 - Stillfront appointed Bonte permanent President & Group CEO.
- Historic M&A run includes Storm8 (\$400M), Candywriter (\$195M), Sandbox Interactive (\$159M) and Nanobit (\$148M) (InvestGame).



Vishnu Vijayakumar

[LinkedIn](#)

Director of Business Development, TaleWorlds Entertainment

Leads business development at TaleWorlds, the Turkish studio behind the Mount & Blade series — driving partnerships, platform deals and commercial strategy for the Bannerlord franchise.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (open-world medieval action-RPG / strategy)
- **Location:** Ankara, Turkey
- **Founded:** 2005 by Armağan Yavuz
- **Headcount:** ~150
- **Ownership:** Independent (brand of İkisoft)
- **Description:** Turkey's best-known game studio, creators of the Mount & Blade series and Bannerlord

Flagship titles

Mount & Blade II: Bannerlord

Launch: 2022

Genre: Medieval
action-RPG / strategy

Mount & Blade: Warband

Launch: 2010

Genre: Action-RPG /
strategy

Recent news & activity

- Mount & Blade II: Bannerlord reached its full 1.0 release after Early Access (2022)
- Brought Bannerlord to PlayStation and Xbox, broadening the audience
- Continues to grow TaleWorlds as one of Turkey's flagship studios
- Supports a large modding community around the Mount & Blade series



Armağan Yavuz

Founder & CEO, TaleWorlds Entertainment

[LinkedIn](#)

Founded TaleWorlds in 2005 and created Mount & Blade as a hobby project that grew into a global franchise. A Bilkent University computer engineer, he keeps every major creative decision true to the original vision.

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Diana Moldavsky

[LinkedIn](#)

Director, Investments & Global Strategic Partnerships, Tencent

Director of Investments & Global Strategic Partnerships at Tencent Games and GM covering CIS, Turkey, Israel and Cyprus; a founding team member of Tencent's Amsterdam HQ focused on cross-border M&A and partnerships.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development, publishing & investment (global)
- **Location:** Shenzhen, China (Europe team in London)
- **Founded:** Tencent founded 1998; games division a global leader
- **Headcount:** ~100k
- **Ownership:** Public (HKEX: 0700)
- **Description:** World's largest games company; investor/stakeholder in Riot, Supercell, Epic, Ubisoft and many more

Flagship titles

Honor of Kings

Launch: 2015

Genre: Mobile MOBA

PUBG Battlegrounds

Launch: 2017

Genre: Battle royale

Recent news & activity

- Acquires minority stakes in gaming studios — most recently Game Science (Black Myth: Wukong) on Apr 30, 2026, plus Wildlight Entertainment, Hungry Studio, and ~\$80M into Helldivers 2 maker Arrowhead
- Backs Western publishers through large public-equity deals — ~\$1.25B into Ubisoft and ~\$39.3M into Kadokawa
- Reportedly in talks to invest in AI startup DeepSeek at a >\$20B valuation
- Expands platform reach - links PayPal to WeChat Pay, renews its 10-year Nexon Dungeon&Fighter China deal, and adds an OpenClaw AI agent to WeChat



Mark Maslowicz

[LinkedIn](#)

VP, Partnerships & Investments, Tencent Games

Leads Tencent Games' partnerships and investments in Europe from London. Spent two decades at Microsoft (incl. Senior Director, Xbox 3rd-Party Publishing) and earlier at SEGA Europe. LSE alumnus.

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Nachuan Li

[LinkedIn](#)

Head of Global Partnerships, Tencent Games

Heads global partnerships at Tencent Games, building relationships with developers and platform holders worldwide and supporting the company's investment and publishing activity. (Further background to be confirmed.)

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Li Ma

[LinkedIn](#)

Director, Investments & Strategic Partnerships, Tencent Games

Works on investments and strategic partnerships at Tencent Games, sourcing and supporting studios across the global games industry. (Further background to be confirmed.)

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Launch: 2015

Genre: Mobile MOBA

PUBG Battlegrounds

Launch: 2017

Genre: Battle royale

Recent news & activity

- Acquires minority stakes in gaming studios — most recently Game Science (Black Myth: Wukong) on Apr 30, 2026, plus Wildlight Entertainment, Hungry Studio, and ~\$80M into Helldivers 2 maker Arrowhead
- Backs Western publishers through large public-equity deals — ~\$1.25B into Ubisoft and ~\$39.3M into Kadokawa
- Reportedly in talks to invest in AI startup DeepSeek at a >\$20B valuation
- Expands platform reach - links PayPal to WeChat Pay, renews its 10-year Nexon Dungeon&Fighter China deal, and adds an OpenClaw AI agent to WeChat



Yiğit Doruk

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & Game Maker, Tenstack

Co-founder and game maker at Tenstack, a studio built on shipping lots of small, focused games. Hands-on across design and development

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Independent game development (small-batch titles)
- **Location:** Sweden
- **Founded:** Co-founded by Yiğit Doruk & Erik Levin de Verdier
- **Headcount:** Small indie team
- **Ownership:** Independent (founder-led)
- **Description:** Studio built on making lots of cool, 'digestible' small games rather than one big title

Flagship titles

Gamble With Your Friends

Launch: 2026

Genre: Casino

Recent news & activity

- Small Stockholm studio (founded 2024), reported as bootstrapped; founders are ex-King and G-Loot.
- Debut title Gamble With Your Friends (1–6 player co-op 'casino crawler') launched May 2026 and crossed 1M sales in its first week.



Erik Levin de Verdier

Co-Founder, Tenstack

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Tenstack alongside Yiğit Doruk, backing the studio's vision of building a company around many small, original games.

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Will Porter

[LinkedIn](#)

Creative Director & Writer, The Indie Stone

Creative director and writer at The Indie Stone, driving the design and writing of Project Zomboid. A former games journalist (PC Zone, Eurogamer) who joined the studio in its early years and helped shape one of the most enduring survival games on Steam.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Independent game development (survival / simulation)
- **Location:** United Kingdom & Canada (remote)
- **Founded:** 2009 by Chris Simpson, Andy Hodgetts & Marina Siu-Chong
- **Headcount:** Small, growing indie team
- **Ownership:** Independent (founder-led)
- **Description:** Creators of Project Zomboid, a long-running isometric zombie survival RPG and Steam best-seller

Flagship titles

Project Zomboid

Launch: 2013

Genre: Zombie survival RPG

Project Zomboid:

Build 42

Launch: 2024

Genre: Survival update

Recent news & activity

- Sales remain strong (6M+ lifetime; ~\$2M in Aug 2025 alone).
- Released Project Zomboid Build 42 multiplayer (unstable) in Dec 2025; as of Mar 2026 the team was in the 'final charge' toward a stable Build 42.
- Hired industry veteran Christian 'Serellan' Allen (Ghost Recon, Halo: Reach) as Design Director; NPCs targeted for Build 43.



Tobias Springer

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO, tobspr Games

Founder and lead developer behind shapez, who turned a solo passion project into tobspr Games. Leads design and direction on the studio's factory-building automation titles, shapez and shapez 2.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (factory-building / automation games)
- **Location:** Germany
- **Founded:** Founded by Tobias Springer around the shapez series
- **Headcount:** Small indie team (~10)
- **Ownership:** Independent (founder-led)
- **Description:** Creators of shapez and shapez 2, minimalist factory-building automation games

Flagship titles

shapez

Launch: 2020

Genre: Factory-building automation

shapez 2

Launch: 2026

Genre: Factory-building automation

Recent news & activity

- Won German federal games funding — ~€2.3M toward a future project plus €320k for a shapez 2 Puzzle DLC.
- Factory-builder shapez 2 set its full 1.0 release for April 2026, after 650k–700k Early Access sales pushed the franchise past 2M copies.



Floyd Horng

Founder & Co-CEO, Uplift Games

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder and Co-CEO of Uplift Games, the studio behind Adopt Me! — one of the most-played experiences on Roblox. Leads a remote-first team building social, family-friendly games at massive scale.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Game development (social / UGC games on Roblox)
- **Location:** Remote-first / distributed team
- **Founded:** Built around Adopt Me! on Roblox
- **Headcount:** Distributed studio (~60)
- **Ownership:** Independent (founder-led)
- **Description:** Studio behind Adopt Me!, one of the most-played and highest-traffic experiences on Roblox

Flagship titles

Adopt Me!
Launch: 2019
Genre: Roblox social
pet game

Recent news & activity

- No funding, M&A, or new (non-Adopt Me) game announced in the last 12 months.
- Adopt Me! passed 40 billion visits on Roblox, remaining one of the platform's most-played experiences.
- Maintains a weekly live-ops cadence (current 'Journey to Summer Camp' series); team ~60, remote-first across North America and the UK.



Jose Sirera

[LinkedIn](#)

Member Representative, Uplift Games

Member representative at Uplift Games, the studio behind the Roblox hit Adopt Me!. Supports the studio's governance and operations as part of its member-led structure.

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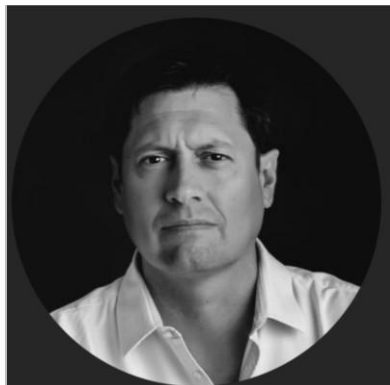
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H O R I Z O N S

Mobile, AdTech &
Consumer



Olivier Comte

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder, President & CEO, 52

Founded 52 Entertainment in 2018. Previously led Koch Media France and Ankama as Managing Director, with earlier roles at Bandai Namco and Infogrames and Infogrames

Company Overview

- **Genre:** E-gaming / evergreen online games
- **Location:** Paris, France (offices in Lille, Tel Aviv & Sofia)
- **Founded:** 2018 by Olivier Comte
- **Headcount:** ~250 employees
- **Ownership:** Majority-owned by HLD Group
- **Description:** Worldwide leader in online bridge, e-sailing and mind & strategy card games, home to BBO, Funbridge and Virtual Regatta

Flagship titles

Virtual Regatta

Launch: 2006

Genre: Sailing sim

Fun Bridge

Launch: 2003

Genre: Online bridge

Recent news & activity

- Acquired Barcelona-based casual studio Blackout (Sept 2024), adding 19.6m monthly players and 344m downloads
- Built an evergreen M&A track record, including Casualino (Bulgaria) and Loop Games
- 52 Entertainment launches Mahjong Wonder, the first Mahjong solitaire game developed by its 52 Paris studio
- Continues to scale global bridge, e-sailing and card-game communities across its platforms



Emilien Eychenne

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder and Chief Growth Officer, Adikteev

Co-founded Adikteev (2012) and is a long-tenured commercial leader; also an active angel investor (Playruo, Actionable, Olyzon etc.). Educated via Mastère Spécialisé HEC Entrepreneurs.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile adtech – app retargeting & re-engagement (performance advertising / DSP)
- **Location:** France (Paris)
- **Founded:** 2012
- **Headcount:** 120
- **Ownership:** Private; founder-led
- **Description:** Paris-based mobile app retargeting/re-engagement platform using predictive/ML targeting; clients include King, Blizzard, Papaya and Superplay

Key Clients



Partners



Recent news & activity

- In Sep-25, Adikteev received a minority investment led by European technology investment platform AgilaCapital to further expand its performance growth solutions for mobile publishers
- The company has shifted focus toward performance-based CTV user acquisition, cross-promotion strategies, and incrementality to help marketers scale their iOS campaigns while achieving return on ad spend (ROAS)
- In Apr-2022, Adikteev acted as lead investor in a \$5.0M early-stage round for Tempur



Xavier Mariani

CEO & Co-Founder, Adikteev

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Adikteev in 2012 and serves as CEO; earlier career in finance/consulting (Roland Berger, Lehman Brothers, Rexel M&A, Innoven Partenaires) and an active angel investor since 2020.

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Key Clients

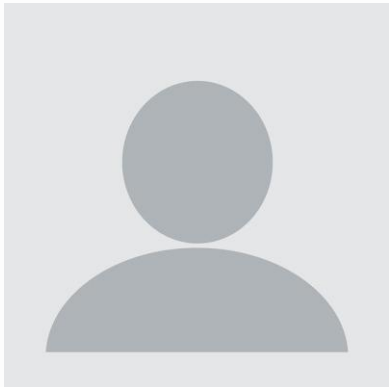


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Pavel Siomin
Co-CEO & Co-CEO, AIBY

[LinkedIn](#)

Listed on roster as Co-CEO of AIBY.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** AI products
- **Location:** United States
- **Founded:** 2019
- **Headcount:** 800+ professional (20 countries, 65% Belarus)
- **Ownership:** Private; owned by founders
- **Description:** US-based company building, acquiring and operating consumer mobile-first apps; known for AI-powered apps including ChatOn, Plantum and others.

Flagship products

ChatOn - AI Chat
Bot Assistant

Launch: 2023

Genre: AI assistant / productivity app
(~100M downloads)

iScanner: PDF
Document Scanner

Launch: ~2015

Genre: Scan Photos
~145M downloads

Recent news & activity

- 70+ products on all platforms
- 3bn+ install worldwide and 100M+ MAU
- [KP Slack Oct-24]: Doing \$300m revenue run rate. said they spend to 130% ROAS in 24 months. 90% subscription
- Nov-25, launched an accelerator initiative providing app creators with up to in funding, marketing budgets, and operational mentorship
- AIBY Launches EpicScale Publisher for Consumer App Developers



Jan Sommerfeld
COO, Almedia

[LinkedIn](#)

COO at Almedia and a serial founder/operator; previously co-founded PrepLounge and Drawlink, was Co-Founder/MD at Lamudi, Myanmar (Rocket Internet) and a venture developer at FoundersLane.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** User Acquisition and Engagement for Mobile Games, Apps, Brands & Retailers
- **Location:** Germany (Berlin)
- **Founded:** 2020
- **Headcount:** 150+
- **Ownership:** Private owned
- **Description:** Berlin-based gamified, reward-based UA platform for mobile games/apps; operator of the Freecash rewards platform, recognized as a fast-growing European company.

Flagship App

Freecash: Earn Money

Launch: 2022

Description:

rewarded marketplace and discoverability tool for users to find games and brands

Recent news & activity

- Apr-26, Freecash was removed from Google Play and from the Apple App Store following scrutiny over data practices; Almedia stated it does not sell user data and remains GDPR-compliant. Google Play was re-installed recently
- \$322M Revenue in 2025, was targeting \$1bn revenue in 2026 (before platform removal)
- Aug-25, Almedia acquired zave.it (M&A control; size undisclosed)
- Previously recognized as one of Europe's fastest-growing companies from Financial Times.



Cyril Caël

[LinkedIn](#)

VP, Business Development EMEA, Applovin

VP, EMEA Business Development at AppLovin (joined 2017), leading developer growth across EMEA from Berlin; frequent industry speaker on mobile market trends. Worked as UA manager at Gameloft.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile adtech / advertising platform (AppDiscovery, MAX in-app bidding, Adjust analytics)
- **Location:** United States (Palo Alto, CA)
- **Founded:** 2012
- **Headcount:** ~898 full-time employees
- **Ownership:** NASDAQ: APP (IPO April 2021); CEO Adam Foroughi
- **Description:** NASDAQ-listed mobile adtech platform for app developers; divested its mobile games business in 2025 to focus on its AI-powered advertising engine.

Flagship products



MEDIATION
PLATFORM AND
REAL-TIME BIDDING
TECHNOLOGY



ADVERTISE
PLATFORM FOR
BUSINESS



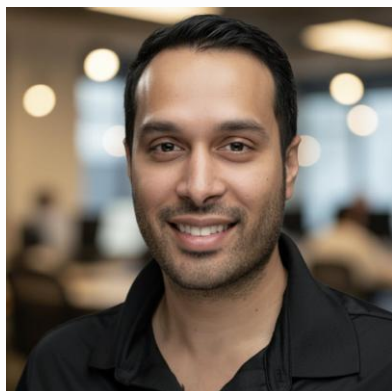
SOLUTIONS THAT
IMPROVE
STREAMING TV



ANALYTICS FOR
MARKETERS

Recent news & activity

- Jun-25, completed sale of its entire mobile gaming business to Tripledot Studios for ~\$800M (\$400M cash + ~20% Tripledot stake); studios included Lion Studios, Belka Games, Machine Zone, PeopleFun
- FY2025: revenue \$5.48B, net income \$3.33B, EPS \$9.84; market cap ~\$193.5B (Jun '26)
- Earlier M&A: MoPub (\$1.05B, 2021), Adjust (\$990M, 2021).



Sami Khan

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO, Atlas Reality

Co-founded Atlas Reality in 2016. Founded Tesoro XP in Apr-25. Scaled Acorns to 2.5m investment accounts. Launched Honey's go-to-market strategy that led them to 1.5m Users. Created and launched Dave.com's go-to-market strategy and more

Company Overview

- **Genre:** A location-based app with the feel of a game
- **Location:** Austin, Texas
- **Founded:** 2017 by Sami Khan, Mudit Seth & Beau Button
- **Headcount:** 30+
- **Ownership:** Private; VC-backed (~\$12M raised)
- **Description:** Builds a real-world metaverse overlaying virtual real estate onto physical locations, paying players cash-redeemable rent

Flagship titles

Atlas Earth

Launch: 2021

Genre: Location-based
~9M downloads

Recent news & activity

- [Slack Apr-26]: Atlas:EARTH saw its best month yet in March - \$6m revenue, 700k+ MAU, ~230k DAU. Subscription revenue nearly at \$1m MRR.
- [Slack Apr-26]: Targeting \$100m ARR and \$10-14m EBITDA by end of 2026
- [Slack Apr-26]: In process of realigning business as cash back focused instead of location-based gaming
- Launched The Atlas Games YouTube series, with up to \$20K in community prizes
- Rolled out new Atlas Earth features – Explorer Club, landmark



Vickie Chen

Founder & CEO, Avia

[LinkedIn](#)

20+ year gaming industry veteran; founded AviaGames in 2017. Founder & CEO of New Code in Jan-26. Earlier held GM and business development roles at Changyou.com and Sohu.com. Cornell MBA

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Skill-based real-money mobile games
- **Location:** Mountain View, California
- **Founded:** 2017 by Vickie Chen
- **Headcount:** 500
- **Ownership:** Private; VC-backed (~\$60M raised)
- **Description:** Builds Pocket7Games, a fair, skill-matched cash-tournament platform spanning 15M+ players across card, bingo, puzzle and sports titles

Flagship titles

Bingo Clash

Launch: 2020

Genre: Bingo
15M+ Downloads

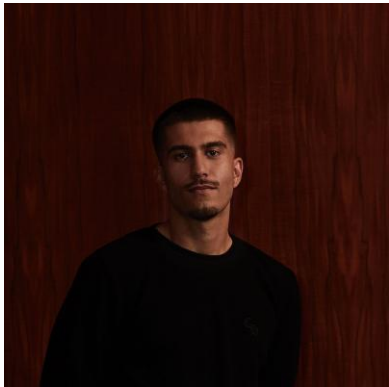
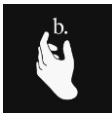
Solitaire Clash

Launch: 2021

Genre: Card
15M+ Downloads

Recent news & activity

- Skillz won a \$42.9 million jury verdict against AviaGames for willfully copying their patented fair-play technology. The two companies later reached an \$80 million settlement and voluntarily dismissed the case.
- Avia launched a Global Trust Center in Singapore to advance data protection and secure transactions for its real-money gaming apps.
- A regional headquarters in Hamburg, Germany, was established to support operational growth and partnership development across Europe.



Fabian Kamberi

Co-Founder & CEO, Born

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder and Forbes 30 Under 30 Europe (2025). Co-founded Born (formerly Slay) in 2022; has shipped five #1 App Store apps with 17M+ downloads

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Consumer AI / social gaming
- **Location:** Berlin, Germany (+ New York office)
- **Founded:** 2022 (as Slay) by Kamberi, Jannis Ringwald & Stefan Quernhorst
- **Headcount:** ~30
- **Ownership:** VC-backed; ~\$25M raised (Tencent, Supercell, Accel, Laton)
- **Description:** Builds social AI companions you raise with real friends; rebranded from Slay to Born in Sept 2025

Flagship titles

Pengu

Launch: 2024

Genre: Social AI pet
~25M Downloads

Recent news & activity

- Raised a \$15m Series A (Sept 2025) from Tencent, Supercell, Accel and Laton, with angels Ilkka Paananen, Riccardo Zacconi, Scott Belsky and Alex Pall
- Rebranded from Slay to Born (Sept 2025) to focus on social AI companions
- Opening a New York office for marketing and AI research



Anatolii Henis

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO, Burny Games

Founder & CEO of Burny Games, a Ukrainian-founded mobile puzzle studio he launched in March 2022; previously Head of Accelerator at MURKA, with earlier product and technology leadership roles, as CPO and CTO

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual / block & color-sort mobile puzzle games (full-cycle dev & publishing)
- **Location:** HQ registered in Cyprus; Ukrainian team/origin
- **Founded:** 2022
- **Headcount:** 140
- **Ownership:** Privately held; founder-led, with Ukrainian entrepreneur Maxim Krippa as co-owner since March 2026
- **Description:** Full-cycle mobile puzzle developer & publisher; portfolio has surpassed 60M downloads and expanded into third-party publishing in 2025.

Flagship titles

Playdoku: Block Puzzle Games

Launch: 2022

Genre: block/sudoku
puzzle

Colorwood Sort Puzzle Game

Launch: 2023

Genre: color-sort
puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Mar '26: InvestGame records a minority M&A transaction with Burny Games as the target (size undisclosed).
- Portfolio surpassed 60M downloads across ~10 titles (as of March 2026).
- Expanded into third-party publishing in 2025.
- Flagship titles Playdoku (5M+ installs) and Colorwood Sort (10M+ installs) both actively updated into 2026.



Xiang Shen

CTO, Century Games

[LinkedIn](#)

CTO of Century Games, leading technology/infrastructure for its mobile and Roblox titles from San Mateo, CA; prior career spans Ubisoft, Tencent, EA and Roblox (infrastructure).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile strategy / survival-builder games (4X-style & city-building); active on Roblox
- **Location:** Singapore / China (Century Games PTE. LTD.)
- **Founded:** 2010
- **Headcount:** 1,500
- **Ownership:** It operates as a subsidiary of Shenzhen-listed Century Huatong (002602.SZ)
- **Description:** Top-20 global mobile publisher best known for Whiteout Survival (~\$500M overseas in-app revenue in a year) and Frozen City; active on Roblox.

Flagship titles

Whiteout Survival

Launch: 2023

Genre: survival
strategy/city-builder

Frozen City

Launch: 2023

Genre: post-
apocalyptic city-building
sim

Recent news & activity

- **Kingshot;** Century Games' idle survival-strategy follow-up to Whiteout Survival, launched on iOS and Android in late February 2025 (Feb 22); it surpassed \$1B in user spending (Mar 2026)
- Whiteout Survival reported ~\$500M overseas in-app revenue in a single year and 300M+ players.
- Whiteout Survival took Google Play Best of 2025 honours (Best on PC / Best Ongoing across several Asian markets)
- Active expansion onto Roblox (infrastructure work led under the CTO).



Ben Liu

CEO, Pocket Gems

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO of Pocket Gems, the San Francisco studio behind Episode and War Dragons. He joined as COO in 2011 and became CEO in 2012, following earlier roles at Playdom (acquired by Disney), EA Mobile, Pandemic Studios and Disney

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile games & interactive entertainment; interactive storytelling and 3D real-time strategy
- **Location:** San Francisco, California
- **Founded:** 2009
- **Headcount:** 192
- **Ownership:** Private/independent; minority investors Tencent (~38%) and Sequoia Capital; ~\$155M raised across 4 rounds
- **Description:** San Francisco-based mobile-games and interactive-entertainment studio with 500M+ downloads and \$1B+ in lifetime revenue.

Flagship titles

Episode – Choose Your Story

Launch: 2013

Genre: Interactive storytelling network

War Dragons

Launch: 2015

Genre: 3D real-time strategy

Recent news & activity

- Backed by Tencent (~38%) and Sequoia Capital; ~\$155M raised total, last round 2017
- Two flagships kept live: Episode (interactive storytelling) and War Dragons (3D RTS), with ongoing content/expansions, built on its proprietary mobile-first Mantis Engine.
- CEO Ben Liu featured in PocketGamer.biz's "Global Trends" CEO series (Dec 2024) ahead of PGC London 2025



Michail Katkoff

Founder & CPO/COO, DOF

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder of games-industry media brand Deconstructor of Fun and a fractional CPO/COO. Venture Investor at Play Venture. Co-founder & CEO of Savage Game Studios (acquired by Sony in 2022), with earlier leadership roles at Zynga, Supercell, FunPlus and Rovio (Head of Studio).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Games-industry media; analysis blog & podcast (mobile/games business)
- **Location:** Espoo, Southern Finland
- **Founded:** 2012
- **Headcount:** 10
- **Ownership:** Independent / founder-owned. No InvestGame record.
- **Description:** Influential games-industry media brand and podcast analyzing the mobile and games business; posts routinely draw 50k+ views.

Products

Deconstructor of Fun (blog/newsletter)

Launch: 2012

Genre: Games-business analysis & F2P deconstructions

DoF Podcast ("This Week in Games")

Launch: 2017

Genre: Weekly games-industry news & analysis

Recent news & activity

- Hosts the Deconstructor of Fun podcast; 2025 episodes include "Mobile Marketing in 2025: What Still Works (and What's Dead)"
- Recorded live on-site at GDC 2025 (San Francisco)
- Guest on the GameMakers podcast discussing the costs of being a startup gaming founder



Vladimir Oane

Co-Founder & CEO, Deepstash

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO of Deepstash, the microlearning and knowledge-curation platform he launched in May 2018 with Dan Ciotu and Cristian Mezei. Previously co-founded social-media analytics startup uberVU (Seedcamp 2008), acquired by Hootsuite in 2014.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Consumer microlearning / knowledge-discovery apps
- **Location:** HQ in Romania
- **Founded:** 2019
- **Headcount:** ~60
- **Ownership:** Private, founders (Oane, Ciotu, Mezei), plus VC equity from Connect Ventures, GapMinder VC and Cultivate Capital
- **Description:** Delaware-incorporated company that owns and operates the Deepstash microlearning/knowledge-discovery app and Paladin: Learn History, via its Romanian subsidiary Deepstash SRL.

Products

Deepstash: Smarter Every Day!

Launch: 2019

Genre: microlearning / knowledge app

Paladin: Learn History

Launch: 2025

Genre: gamified history learning

Recent news & activity

- Freemium subscription model with 200,000+ curated idea cards from books, podcasts and articles
- ~1M MAU and ~\$50M Jan-25 Runrate Revenue
- Raised \$9M in user-acquisition (UA) financing from PvX Partners (Nov 2025), non-dilutive, performance-based, to scale Deepstash's global growth
- Launched Paladin: Learn History (mid 2025), expanding from microlearning into gamified history education (~550K+ downloads)



Franziska Meyer

Co-Founder & Co-CEO, Edurino

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder of Edurino (with Irene Klemm), Munich, 2021. Worked as an associate at BCG. Named (with co-founder) "Female Founders of the Year 2025" by the German Startup Association.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Kids EdTech, hybrid digital-physical learning system (ages ~4–8+)
- **Location:** Munich, Germany
- **Founded:** 2021
- **Headcount:** 78
- **Ownership:** Private, VC-backed (Jens (wooga) and Ben (Yoto founder) are angel)
- **Description:** German EdTech offering a learning app + ergonomic stylus paired with collectible animal figurines that unlock curriculum-aligned content (reading, maths, coding, English, logic).

Products

EDURINO

Launch: 2021

Genre: kids EdTech
learning app (ad-free, no IAP)

Recent news & activity

- Closed a €17M Series B (Jul 2025) led by Ravensburger Next Ventures and Summiteer; earmarked for platform development, UK rollout and doubling retail presence..
- Interdisciplinary team of 40+ educators, designers and scientists; learning effects evaluated with the University of Cambridge.



Irene Klemm

Co-Founder & Co-CEO, Edurino

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder of Edurino (with Franziska Meyer), Munich, 2021, owning the B2C area (marketing, app, people); previously at Boston Consulting Group, where she met her co-founder.

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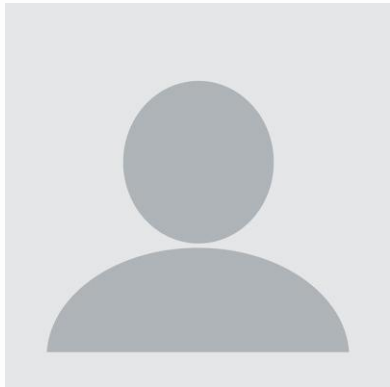
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Duong Tuyen

Chief Financial Officer, Falcon Game Studio

Finance executive at one of Vietnam's leading mobile-game studios, overseeing financial strategy, planning and operations. Falcon (a OneSoft studio, founded 2017) is known for global hits including 1945 Air Force and Falcon Squad, with multiple titles surpassing 100M+ downloads.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile games (arcade shooters, casual, hyper-casual) — development & publishing
- **Location:** Vietnam (Hanoi)
- **Founded:** 1 April 2017
- **Headcount:** ~150+ employees
- **Ownership:** Private; part of the OneSoft group
- **Description:** Fast-growing Vietnamese mobile game developer/publisher; reportedly 500+ games launched, several surpassing 100M downloads, ~3B cumulative downloads.

Flagship titles

1945 Air Force

Launch: 2017

Genre: Arcade shoot-'em-up

Falcon Squad

Launch: 2017

Genre: Pixel arcade shooter

Recent news & activity

- Privately held; limited public financial disclosure.
- Reported portfolio of 500+ titles and ~3B cumulative downloads; "1945 Air Force" named Editor's Choice in South Korea.
- Multiple titles featured in Google Play Editor's Choice across regions.



Fatih Haltas

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder, Matchingham Games

Founder of Breeze Games since February 2024 and Founder of Matchingham Games (mobile games; 500M+ downloads, 30M MAU); 10+ years in mobile product, publishing, monetization and UA. Educated at Oxford (Saïd), NYU and Bilkent.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Hybrid-casual mobile games; also publishes for ~20 partner studios worldwide
- **Location:** Leicester, UK
- **Founded:** 2020
- **Headcount:** 137
- **Ownership:** Private, founder-led
- **Description:** UK hybrid-casual mobile games developer and publisher (founded 2020), known for its in-house Braindom quiz series and for publishing partner studios globally.

Flagship titles

Food Match 3D: Tile Puzzle

Launch: 2021

Genre: tile/match
hybrid-casual puzzle

Braindom: Brain Games Test Out

Launch: 2020

Genre: quiz / brain-teaser puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Matchingham Games reports 750M+ downloads and ~30M monthly active users.
- Matchingham recognized as a "Rising Star" at the Google Play / App awards.
- Ranked #692 on the FT Europe's Fastest-Growing Companies 2025.
- Haltas is an angel investor (UK Business Angels Association) and a Board Member at Oak Technology.



Charles Chapman

CEO & Founder, FTG

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of First Touch Games since 2011 and the developer behind the Dream League Soccer and Score! Hero franchises. Previously co-founded Exient (2001) and grew it to a 50+ person studio.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile sports (soccer)
- **Location:** Oxford, United Kingdom
- **Founded:** 2011
- **Headcount:** 45
- **Ownership:** Privately held; founder Charlie Chapman reported as largest shareholder (~90% per UK filings, unconfirmed exact figure)
- **Description:** Independent UK mobile games studio focused on mobile sports titles, best known for Dream League Soccer and the Score! franchise.

Flagship titles

Dream League Soccer 2026

Launch: 2020

Genre: Mobile soccer

Score! Hero

Launch: 2015

Genre: Mobile soccer
(skill-based)

Recent news & activity

- Score! Hero (the 2015 original) still actively maintained. Latest build released Feb 27, 2025, with 100M+ estimated downloads; a decade-old title kept in live-ops alongside Score! Match.
- Across Dream League Soccer, Score! Hero, Score! Match and First Touch Soccer, the studio has achieved over 1B downloads of its games



Paul West
CEO & Founder, Fumb Games

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of Fumb Games, a hyper-idle studio behind Bitcoin Miner and SpaceY, with a positioning around Bitcoin-rewarded gameplay. Prior experience at AdColony and Neon Play.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual idle/tycoon (Bitcoin-rewarded)
- **Location:** United Kingdom
- **Founded:** 2015
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** Privately held; raised \$12.0M UA financing (Sep 2025)
- **Description:** UK mobile studio focused on casual idle and tycoon titles combining idle progression with IAP, advertising, and real-Bitcoin reward mechanics.

Flagship titles

Bitcoin Miner: Idle Tycoon Game
Launch: 2021
Genre: Idle/tycoon (crypto rewards)

Idle Mine! Tycoon Mining Game
Launch: n/a
Genre: Idle/tycoon mining

Recent news & activity

- 2025-09-23 — Fumb Games raised a \$12.0M UA financing round.
- Partnered with ZEBEDEE on a Bitcoin-mining simulator (Bitcoin Magazine).
- West is a frequent web3/blockchain-gaming commentator (BlockchainGamer.biz interviews); active on X as @pau1west.



Michael Martinez
CEO & Co-Founder, Fun Craft

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO & Co-Founder of FunCraft since 2019. Former Studio GM at Electronic Arts, founder/CEO of Juicebox Games, and an early Zynga product manager.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual word & puzzle (daily-ritual)
- **Location:** USA
- **Founded:** 2019
- **Headcount:** n/a (small studio)
- **Ownership:** Privately held; venture-backed (seed)
- **Description:** US mobile studio focused on daily-ritual word and puzzle games, publishing since 2019.

Flagship titles

Wordgrams -
Crossword & Puzzle
Launch: 2020
Genre:
Word/crossword
(multiplayer)

Spelling Bee -
Crossword Puzzle
Game
Launch: 2020
Genre: Word puzzle

Recent news & activity

- 2020-02-26 — FunCraft raised a \$1.8M Seed round (InvestGame).
- Catalogue also includes Merge Kingdoms - Tower Defense and Farkle Dice.
- Martinez frequently posts on building daily-habit casual games and his Zynga/EA background.



Chris Petrovic

[LinkedIn](#)

Board Chairman & Chief Business Officer, FunPlus

Chief Business Officer and Board Member at FunPlus (CBO since Feb 2021) with 20+ years in games, tech, and digital media. Previously led M&A at Zynga (Rollic, Peak Games, Small Giant) and corporate strategy at Kabam and GameStop Digital Ventures.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** F2P strategy (mobile publisher/developer)
- **Location:** Switzerland (offices in 10+ cities, 6 countries)
- **Founded:** 2010
- **Headcount:** 500+
- **Ownership:** Privately held; large independent F2P publisher
- **Description:** Independent F2P video game publisher and developer behind State of Survival, King of Avalon, and Kingdom Guard; also an active strategic/CVC investor.

Flagship titles

State of Survival:

Zombie War

Launch: 2019

Genre: F2P strategy
(zombie MMO)

Frost & Flame: King of Avalon

Launch: 2016

Genre: F2P strategy
MMO

Recent news & activity

- In recorded InvestGame deals, FunPlus appears mainly as an investor - e.g., a \$40.0M early-stage lead in Aug 2022 and a \$30.0M Series B lead in Jul 2021.
- Petrovic featured in FunPlus's 2025 Half-Year Review.
- Guest on the GameMakers podcast and Deconstructor of Fun's "M&A Master Class"; slated for a fireside chat at PGC Barcelona.



Saad Hameed

CEO & Co-Founder, Game District

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO & Co-Founder of Game District, Pakistan's largest mobile games studio, built without venture capital. Credits a high-frequency production engine plus centralised data and UA for the company's scale.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual / hyper-casual / simulation (mobile)
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan (studios also in Istanbul & Dubai)
- **Founded:** 2016
- **Headcount:** 250+
- **Ownership:** Privately held / bootstrapped
- **Description:** Pakistan-based mobile developer/publisher with 5B+ downloads across 80+ casual titles, operating across the MENAP region.

Flagship titles

My Supermarket Simulator 3D
Launch: 2024
Genre: Hybrid Casual

Annoying Uncle Punch Game
Launch: 2024
Genre: Hyper Casual

Recent news & activity

- Hyper-casual transitioning into hybrid-casual
- Nov '24, Game District acquired Gleam Games (size undisclosed).
- Passed 2.2B+ downloads worldwide in 2025; cited as Pakistan's biggest games ad spender.
- Hameed featured on Deconstructor of Fun ep. 295, "Pakistan's Unexpected Rise in Gaming" (Jul 2025).



Phillip Black

Economist / Founder, GEC

[LinkedIn](#)

Game economist running Game Economist Consulting and associated with The Experimentation Group; consults on in-game economies, player behaviour, and monetisation. Prior in-house roles at Amazon Games and DICE/EA (Battlefield 2042, Star Wars Battlefront II).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Games consulting (economy design & monetisation)
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- **Founded:** 2022
- **Headcount:** Solo/boutique advisory
- **Ownership:** Founder-owned consultancy
- **Description:** Specialist consulting practice focused on game-economy design, player behaviour, and analytics-driven monetisation/growth.

Client types

- **Blockchain / Crypto:** Work together to build sustainable and profitable game economies and tokens.
- **HD / Mobile:** Cosmetics, battle pass, systems design, IAP, and store optimization
- **Other:** Gamification across theme parks, social media, and tech apps.

Recent news & activity

- **Services offered**
 - Economic Design & Counsel – pre-launch and live game economy modelling, progression and price tuning
 - State-of-the-Union – reviewing live game data, assessing trajectory, recommending actions
 - Analytics & Product Support – telemetry design in SQL/Tableau/RShiny, A/B experiments, LiveOps tooling
- Hosts the Game Economist Cast; 2025 episodes include a GDC 2025 roundtable and a discussion with Alex Seropian on Fortnite/UEFN creator monetisation.
- Contributor/co-host associated with Deconstructor of Fun.



Joppe Houpt

Founder & Director, Gamovation

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder and Director of GamoVation (co-founded 2010), overseeing marketing, product development, and daily operations. Built websites and online projects young before focusing on games.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual puzzle / board (match & tile games)
- **Location:** Zwolle, Netherlands
- **Founded:** 2010
- **Headcount:** ~50
- **Ownership:** Acquired by Miniclip (M&A control, Apr 2024); classified strategic/CVC by InvestGame
- **Description:** Dutch mobile developer/publisher focused on casual puzzle and board-style titles (Mahjong Club, Tile Club); games reported at 150M+ installs.

Flagship titles

Mahjong Club - Solitaire Game

Launch: 2022

Genre: Casual puzzle (mahjong solitaire)

Mahjong Triple - Match 3 Tile

Launch: 2024

Genre: Casual puzzle (tile match-3)

Recent news & activity

- 2024-04-01 — GamoVation acquired by Miniclip (M&A control, size undisclosed).
- Mahjong Club remains a top-rated long-tail casual hit (live since Dec 2021).
- Houpt continues to lead product and operations from Zwolle post-acquisition.



Dmitri Lipnitsky

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & Non-Executive Director
(former CEO), GISMART

Co-Founded Gismart in 2013 and served as CEO; now Non-Executive Director & Co-Founder. Connected across a cluster of ventures including Hitapps, GeoZilla, HelpCrunch, and SE Ranking.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Consumer apps portfolio (music, health & wellness, utilities; gaming-adjacent)
- **Location:** London, United Kingdom (remote-first)
- **Founded:** 2013
- **Headcount:** 250+
- **Ownership:** Privately held; founder/operator-owned
- **Description:** London-HQ'd, remote-first app developer across Health & Wellness, Utilities, and Music with 1B+ downloads; runs a publishing division.

Flagship titles

Dancebit

Launch: 2021

Genre: Health and Fitness

Luvly

Launch: 2020

Genre: Health and Fitness

Recent news & activity

- Consumer subscription apps business with a portfolio of top wellness apps
- EBITDA in 2024, tracking to \$30m in 2025; January 2025 showed 100% YoY growth across all metrics - management is not under pressure to transact
- Has received two offers from listed strategics, with the best bid at approximately 6x EBITDA; sellers are anchoring at \$200m and expected to revisit the process in Q2 or Q4 2026
- Near-term growth driven by LTV optimisation, customer acquisition and product innovation, with longer-term upside from new app launches and a unified Super App



Ilker Ilicali

Founder & CEO, Good Job Games

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO who bootstrapped Good Job Games into one of the world's largest hypercasual studios before its pivot to mid-core match-3 puzzle.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual puzzle / match-3 (pivoted from hypercasual)
- **Location:** Istanbul, Turkey
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** ~120
- **Ownership:** Privately held; venture-backed (Menlo Ventures, Anthos Capital, Bessemer)
- **Description:** Istanbul mobile developer/publisher that transitioned from hypercasual to mid-core match-3 (Wonder Blast, Match Villains); reported 3.5B+ players reached.

Flagship titles

Match Villains
Launch: Nov 2024
Genre: Match-3

Recent news & activity

- Currently building a hybridcasual portfolio under GJG 3.0, demonstrating a consistent track record of identifying and leading breakout categories across every major casual category
- Launched Match Villains in 2024, achieving Top 10 grossing game status and best-in-class Match-3 product
- Pioneered the tile category with Zen Match (2020–2024), reaching Top 10 grossing puzzle game (acquired by Moon Active)
- Grew to become the #2 hypercasual studio globally with 3B+ downloads, with its hypercasual catalogue acquired by Azur Games



Nazim Akmandil

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & COO, Good Job Games

Co-Founder and COO of Good Job Games with a background in product management and business development. Previously VP of Business Development at caresyntax (digital healthcare/surgical).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual puzzle / match-3 (pivoted from hypercasual)
- **Location:** Istanbul, Turkey
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** ~120
- **Ownership:** Privately held; venture-backed (Menlo Ventures, Anthos Capital, Bessemer)
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Flagship titles

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Launch: Nov 2024
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- Grew to become the #2 hypercasual studio globally with 3B+ downloads, with its hypercasual catalogue acquired by Azur Games



Katerina Dudinskaya

CEO, Goodville

[LinkedIn](#)

Promoted from CMO to CEO of Goodville AG effective 1 May 2025, succeeding co-founder Alexey Meleshkevich. 10+ years in gaming marketing; previously at Easybrain and led a 60+ person marketing team at Gismart.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual farming sim + wellbeing
- **Location:** Switzerland
- **Founded:** 2019
- **Headcount:** ~150
- **Ownership:** Privately held (Goodville AG)
- **Description:** Developer of Goodville: Farm Game Adventure, blending a farming simulator with mental-health/wellbeing features; reported 5.5M+ players. Has partnered with the WHO.

Flagship titles

Goodville: Farm Game Adventure
Launch: 2019
Genre: Casual farming sim + wellbeing

Recent news & activity

- Goodville reached \$55m gross revenue run rate in Jan-26 (#1 farming game by revenue growth in 2025)
- Launching Chinese version of the game in Q3/4-26
- Discussing UA financing facility with vgames VC
- Goodville collaborated with the World Health Organization (character "Florence") on wellbeing initiatives; later added AI mental-health features.



Valery Kurilov

Founder & CEO, Hitapps

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of Hitapps with 10+ years as an executive/entrepreneur and self-described serial investor. Also Co-Founder & former CEO of SE Ranking and a publishing partner at Gismart.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Utility/casual mobile apps portfolio
- **Location:** Cyprus (per founder's LinkedIn; formal HQ unconfirmed)
- **Founded:** n/a
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** Founder-led; part of the Gismart/SE Ranking network
- **Description:** App developer of utility/casual mobile apps within the same founder network as Gismart and SE Ranking; limited public company detail.

Flagship titles

Solitaire
Associations Journey
Launch: 2025
Genre: hybrid casual puzzle

Figgerits
Launch: 2022
Genre: Puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Kurilov also co-founded Intellectsoft and advises/invests in GeoZilla.
- Sits within the connected Gismart - Hitapps - SE Ranking founder/operator cluster.



Daniel Nathan

CEO & Co-Founder, Homa

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO of Homa Games. Prior AdTech/UA background at BidMotion, DataLift (acquired by AppLift), and Deloitte Luxembourg. Named in the Top 30 Mobile Gaming Leaders 2025.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Hyper-casual / hybrid-casual / idle (+ Homa Lab creator toolset)
- **Location:** Paris, France
- **Founded:** 2018
- **Headcount:** 200+
- **Ownership:** Privately held
- **Description:** Paris mobile publisher focused on hyper-casual, idle, and hybrid-casual titles plus the data-driven Homa Lab toolset; catalogue passed ~2B downloads with ~150M MAU.

Flagship titles

All-in-Hole

Launch: 2024

Genre: Puzzle

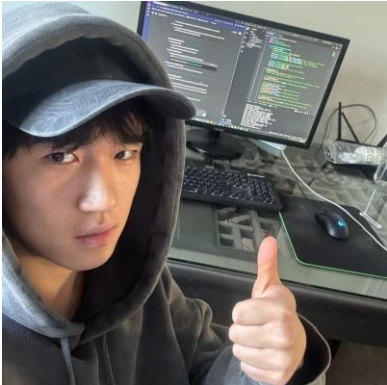
Wall Brawl

Launch: 2025

Genre: Tower Defence

Recent news & activity

- Apr-25 RR Net Revenue of ~\$165M (o/w ~\$120M of A-i-H)
- They Soft launched 2 new games:
 - Bulle Heroes (RPG Shooter)
 - Harvest King (Strategy)
- They are open for a sale to grow All-in-Hole, launch new Forever Franchise games and clean the Cap Table



Michael Qian
CEO, Kairos

[LinkedIn](#)

Kairos Data founder, Huge Games owner with game-developing experience as well as optimizing, leading, and operating studios.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Monetization engine
- **Location:** Canada
- **Founded:** 2025
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** Privately held by founder
- **Description:** ML monetization engine for Roblox Studios

Key activations

Jurassic World
Rebirth

Launch: 2025
Genre: Survival

Fortune Island

Launch: 2025
Genre: Adventure

Recent news & activity

- Tied to the 2025 Jurassic World film, Kairos helped weave the IP into three popular Roblox experiences (Fisch, A Dusty Trip, Chained).
- Integrated brands into Sam’s Club and Fortune Island as part of its offering.



Du Xueqian

Co-CEO, Hungry Studio

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-CEO of Hungry Studio, the mobile games company behind the global puzzle hit Block Blast!. Helps steer the studio's strategy as it scales one of the most-played casual games in the world.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual block-puzzle
- **Location:** Hong Kong (team in Beijing)
- **Founded:** 2025
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** Privately held; Tencent reportedly acquiring a minority stake (2026)
- **Description:** Casual mobile developer/publisher best known for block-puzzle hit Block Blast!, emphasising data-driven experimentation and global scaling. NOTE: Du Xueqian (listed on the roster under "Embracer Group") is a Co-Founder here.

Flagship titles

Block Blast!

Launch: 2022

Genre: Casual block-puzzle

Recent news & activity

- 2026-02 — Tencent reportedly in talks for a 20–30% minority stake.
- Block Blast! briefly disappeared from Google Play (late May 2026) before being restored, boasting over 22M L30 day downloads.
- Yang has presented with Unity on ad quality/monetisation for Block Blast!.



Jerry Yang (Yang Zhe)
VP of Product Strategy, Hungry Studio

[LinkedIn](#)

VP of Product Strategy at Hungry Studio, based in Beijing; has spoken publicly (e.g., with Unity) on ad quality and monetisation for Block Blast!. Prior roles at Ghost Studio, Facebook, Zenjoy, and Cheetah Mobile.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual block-puzzle
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Carl Livie
Co-CEO & Co-Founder, JustPlay

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & Co-CEO of JustPlay GmbH, based in Berlin. Prior roles at Soft Baked Apps, Gimica (Managing Director), and AppLovin.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Rewards/adtech (rewarded mobile gaming)
- **Location:** Berlin, Germany
- **Founded:** 2020
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** NCSoft acquiring 70% (2026, ~\$202M); founders retain remainder
- **Description:** German rewards-gaming platform and adtech company operating the JustPlay app — fusing rewarded gameplay, in-house games, and payouts for 25M+ players.

Flagship titles

JustPlay: Earn Money or Donate
Launch: 2020
Genre:
Rewards/adtech
(rewarded gaming)

Recent news & activity

- 2026-03-10 — NCSoft to acquire 70% of JustPlay for ~\$202M (InvestGame deal); \$172.8M 2025 revenue.
- 2022-03-23 — earlier M&A control transaction (undisclosed) (InvestGame deal).
- Deal anchors NCSoft's casual-gaming expansion; close expected by 30 Apr 2026.
- ~1.4M downloads in L30 days.



Stephan Beinert

CFO, JustPlay

[LinkedIn](#)

CFO of JustPlay Group and MD of Gimica Games. Formerly, Senior Associate at Stern Stewart & Co and Director of Business Process Management / Head of Global Finance Transformation at Fresenius Medical Care.

Company Overview

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- Deal anchors NCSOFT's casual-gaming expansion; close expected by 30 Apr 2026.
- ~1.4M downloads in L30 days.



Bader AlZamil

CEO & Founder, Kammelna

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO/founder of Kammelna and Managing Director of Remal Ventures. Prior experience at Raz Group and GFH Financial Group.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Social card/board games (digitised Baloot)
- **Location:** Dammam, Saudi Arabia
- **Founded:** 2009
- **Headcount:** 40+ professionals (largest independent gaming employer in Saudi Arabia)
- **Ownership:** Impact46 acquired/invested \$53M (Aug 2025); operates under/with Remal Ventures
- **Description:** Saudi gaming studio best known for digitising the popular card game Baloot (and Areeb World), operating within Remal Ventures.

Flagship titles

Kammelna (كاملنا)

Launch: n/a

Genre: Social card games (Baloot & Jackaroo)

Recent news & activity

- 2025-08-23 — Impact46 invested 200M+ SAR (~\$53M) — Impact46's largest-ever deal — unveiled at NGSC25 alongside the Esports World Cup, Riyadh. (Not in InvestGame.)
- Described as the largest regional gaming transaction; aligns with Saudi Vision 2030 gaming/esports strategy.
- Kammelna reported 6M+ downloads and 1M+ monthly active users.



Vishal Mahtani

Founder & Chairman of the Board,
Kashkick

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder of Besitos/KashKick with 20+ years in digital marketing and growth; recently transitioned from CEO to Chairman of the Board. Previously helped grow Kindermint (acquired by ThredUp) and The Penny Hoarder.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Rewards/adtech (get-paid-to platform)
- **Location:** Tampa, Florida, United States
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** 50+
- **Ownership:** Privately held (Besitos Corporation, LLC)
- **Description:** Consumer-rewards company rewarding users for time/attention; flagship products KashKick and the Besitos Marketplace.

Flagship titles

KashKick: Get paid to have fun
Launch: n/a
Genre:
Rewards/adtech

Recent news & activity

- \$100M topline and \$10-15M EBITDA
- Besitos ranked on the Inc. 5000 (#11 in 2024, #22 in 2025), signalling rapid revenue growth.
- Leadership transition: Mahtani moved from CEO to Chairman of the Board.



Cristobal Viedma

Founder & CEO, Lingokids

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of Lingokids since 2015; Former Head of Platform at Viki, researcher at KTH, and founder/CEO of Bluewalks.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Kids EdTech
- **Location:** Madrid, Spain
- **Founded:** 2014 (app launched 2015); co-founded with Marieta Viedma
- **Headcount:** n/a
- **Ownership:** Privately held; venture-backed (Bullhound Capital, General Catalyst, Nextalia)
- **Description:** Madrid educational-entertainment ("Playlearning") company best known for its ad-free learning app for children aged 2–8.

Flagship titles

Lingokids - Play and Learn

Launch: 2015

Genre: Kids EdTech

Recent news & activity

- 2025-09-16 — \$120M round led by Bullhound Capital & General Catalyst's Customer Value Fund (InvestGame logs the late-stage \$120.0M).
- Prior rounds: 2021-06-15 Series C \$40.0M; 2020-10-07 Series B \$10.0M.
- Funds earmarked for AI-driven content production and more third-party brands (Disney, Marvel); reported 185M+ users.



Emre Çelik
Co-Founder & CTO, Loom

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Istanbul-based Loom Games in 2025 and serves as CTO, leading the tech behind hybrid-casual hit Pixel Flow!. Remains in role following Scopely's Feb 2026 majority-stake deal.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Hybrid-casual / puzzle
- **Location:** Istanbul, Türkiye
- **Founded:** 2025
- **Headcount:** ~20 (per press)
- **Ownership:** Majority owned by Scopely (Feb 2026, valuation >\$1B); co-founders retain stakes/roles
- **Description:** Istanbul mobile studio behind hybrid-casual puzzle hit Pixel Flow! (10M+ players in ~6 months); became one of Türkiye's fastest "Turcorns" after Scopely's billion-dollar-valuation deal.

Flagship titles

Pixel Flow!
Launch: 2025
Genre: Action-puzzle
(hybrid-casual)

Recent news & activity

- Loom has achieved more than 50 million global downloads, with 2 major hits out of 6 releases
- Pixel Flow became a breakout hit with 10m+ installs in less than three months and broke into the U.S. monthly top grossing charts
- The team pioneered an innovative casual puzzle mechanic that demonstrated exceptional product market fit and rapid scaling
- Scopely acquired Loom at \$1bn+ valuation



Kübra Gündoğan

Co-Founder & CEO, Loom

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Loom Games in 2025 with Emre Çelik and serves as CEO of the studio behind Pixel Flow!. Won the GamesBeat BOSS Mode "Future Boss Rising Star" award in 2026; remains CEO after Scopely's majority-stake deal.

Company Overview

- Genre:** Hybrid-casual / puzzle
- Location:** Istanbul, Türkiye
- Founded:** 2025
- Headcount:** ~20 employees
- Ownership:** Majority owned by Scopely (Feb 2026, valuation >\$1B); co-founders retain stakes/roles
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Flagship titles

Pixel Flow!
Launch: 2025
Genre: Action-puzzle
(hybrid-casual)

Pixel Flow! (iOS)
Launch: 2025
Genre: Action-puzzle
_(single-flagship studio
to date)_

Recent news & activity

- Loom has achieved more than 50 million global downloads, with 2 major hits out of 6 releases
- Pixel Flow became a breakout hit with 10m+ installs in less than three months and broke into the U.S. monthly top grossing charts
- The team pioneered an innovative casual puzzle mechanic that demonstrated exceptional product market fit and rapid scaling
- Scopely acquired Loom at \$1bn+ valuation



Onur Işık
COO, Loom

[LinkedIn](#)

Chief Operating Officer at Loom Games, cited publicly as a notable addition to the team around the Scopely deal. Limited public background beyond his Loom Games association (prior roles unconfirmed).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Hybrid-casual / puzzle
- **Location:** Istanbul, Türkiye
- **Founded:** 2025
- **Headcount:** ~20 employees
- **Ownership:** Majority owned by Scopely (Feb 2026, valuation >\$1B)
- **Description:** Istanbul mobile studio behind hybrid-casual puzzle hit Pixel Flow! (10M+ players in ~6 months); one of Türkiye's fastest "Turcorns" after Scopely's billion-dollar-valuation deal.

Flagship titles

Pixel Flow!

Launch: 2025

Genre: Action-puzzle
(hybrid-casual)

Pixel Flow! (iOS)

Launch: 2025

Genre: Action-puzzle
_(single-flagship studio
to date)_

Recent news & activity

- Loom has achieved more than 50 million global downloads, with 2 major hits out of 6 releases
- Pixel Flow became a breakout hit with 10m+ installs in less than three months and broke into the U.S. monthly top grossing charts
- The team pioneered an innovative casual puzzle mechanic that demonstrated exceptional product market fit and rapid scaling
- Scopely acquired Loom at \$1bn+ valuation



Jimmy Gendron

CEO, Ludia

[LinkedIn](#)

CEO of Montreal-based Ludia (GM since 2022; CEO from March 2025), he led the studio's 2025 buyout returning it to Canadian ownership. Earlier VP of Mobile Publishing at Behaviour Interactive and Executive Producer at EA.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Licensed mid-core mobile (collection/strategy, AR)
- **Location:** Montreal, Canada
- **Founded:** 2007
- **Headcount:** ~250 employees
- **Ownership:** Canadian institutional investors + management (acquired from Jam City, Mar 2025); founder Alexandre Thabet rejoined as board chairman
- **Description:** Montreal developer of licensed cross-platform mobile games (Jurassic World, DreamWorks Dragons); returned to Canadian ownership in 2025 after a 2021 Jam City acquisition.

Flagship titles

Jurassic World Alive

Launch: 2018

Genre: AR location-based collection/strategy

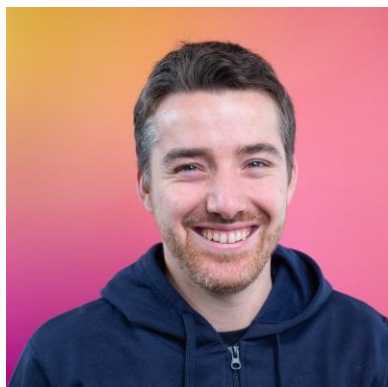
Jurassic World: The Game

Launch: 2015

Genre: Build-and-battle simulation

Recent news & activity

- Mar 2025 — Ludia completed its buyout from Jam City, returning to Canadian (Québec) ownership; Gendron appointed CEO.
- 2025 — Gendron outlined plans to add ~50 jobs and pursue M&A, aiming to "build the next leading independent publisher in Canada."
- 2021 — Acquired by Jam City for ~\$165M (InvestGame); deal Gendron helped drive as GM.



Maxime Demeure

Co-Founder & CEO, Madbox

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Madbox in 2015, serving as COO before becoming CEO in Jan 2022. Leads a "creative brute-force" strategy of rapid prototyping behind hits like Stickman Hook and Pocket Champs.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual / hypercasual mobile
- **Location:** Paris, France
- **Founded:** 2015
- **Headcount:** ~140 employees
- **Ownership:** Private / VC-backed (Series A in 2019)
- **Description:** French mobile studio that creates and self-publishes casual titles with roots in hypercasual; combines rapid prototyping with live-ops optimization.

Flagship titles

Stickman Hook

Launch: 2018

Genre: Casual / arcade

Pocket Champs: 3D

Racing Games

Launch: 2021

Genre: Casual
racing/sim

Recent news & activity

- Madbox reports ~600M installs and ~250% revenue growth between 2021 and 2024, having launched ~240 games in two years to test/optimize quickly.
- 2019 — Raised ~\$16.7M Series A.
- Demeure publicly emphasizes company culture, team trust and creative growth in recent interviews/talks.



Ümit Boncukçu CEO & Founder, Magiclab

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded MagicLab in 2013 with university friend Tolga Şen, pioneering hyper-casual games before scaling into hyper-casual & hybrid-casual

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual & hybrid-casual mobile games
- **Location:** Ankara, Turkey
- **Founded:** 2013
- **Headcount:** ~70
- **Ownership:** Privately held (Boot-strapped)
- **Description:** MagicLab Game Technologies is an Ankara-based studio (METU Technopolis) that designs, develops and publishes casual and hybrid-casual mobile games. A hyper-casual pioneer, its hits include That's My Seat and Connect Master

Flagship titles

That's My Seat

Launch: 2024

Genre: Logic puzzle

Connect Master

Launch: 2025

Genre: Logic Puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Shifting from hyper-casual to casual/hybrid-casual, with new puzzle titles like Connect Master and That's My Seat published via Rooftop.
- Multi-year publishing partnership with Voodoo; long-running hits Run Race 3D & Fun Race 3D among most-downloaded mobile games.



Phil Mohr
CEO, Metica

[LinkedIn](#)

Serial entrepreneur (15+ years in mobile gaming) who co-founded Metica in 2022 — his third venture with Puli Liyanagama. Previously co-founded Comufy (acquired by King) and DataTiger (acquired by Apple); holds a PhD in Machine Learning.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** AdTech / UA & monetization platform (not a game studio)
- **Location:** United Kingdom (London)
- **Founded:** 2022
- **Headcount:** ~20 employees
- **Ownership:** VC-backed (Seed led by Play Ventures, Firstminute Capital, 13books; King-founder angels)
- **Description:** AI-driven user-acquisition and monetization platform for game developers (LTV optimization via IAPs, rewarded ads, LiveOps); also deploys UA financing via "Metica Fuel."

Flagship titles

Metica platform

Metica Fuel (UA financing)

Recent news & activity

- Apr 27, 2026 — Metica provided \$20.0M in UA financing to Metasports Interactive (Hitwicket) — its largest disclosed Fuel deal.
- Jan 16, 2026 — \$5.0M UA credit facility to Turborilla; Nov 26, 2025 — \$5.0M to Gear Games.
- Jan 16, 2025 — Closed a \$9.0M seed round; Mohr was a GDC 2025 speaker.



Benoît Ducrest

CEO, Million Victories

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Million Victories in 2017 with Céline Allary and serves as CEO, leading the studio behind 4X strategy hit Million Lords. His career began at Ubisoft; he previously co-founded Fast Expand and In Ciné.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mid-core strategy (real-time 4X)
- **Location:** France (Lyon)
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** ~60 employees
- **Ownership:** VC/PE-backed; Haveli Investments invested ~\$40M (Jul 2025)
- **Description:** French mobile studio known for Million Lords, a real-time 4X strategy game designed without timer mechanics; has roughly doubled revenue annually since founding.

Flagship titles

Million Lords: World Conquest

Launch: 2018

Genre: Real-time 4X / MMO strategy

N/A — single flagship studio

Genre: Real-time 4X strategy

Recent news & activity

- Jul 9, 2025 — Secured nearly \$40M from U.S. PE firm Haveli Investments to fund global expansion.
- 2021 & 2023 — Earlier Series A rounds of \$3.0M and \$6.5M.
- Ducrest has discussed Million Lords' milestones and timer-free design philosophy in industry interviews.



Babar Ahmed

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO, Mindstorm Studios

Co-founded Lahore-based Mindstorm Studios in 2006 with brother Faraz Ahmed, building one of Pakistan's most prominent studios (Whacksy Taxi, Cricket Revolution). Also head of strategy & technology at Lion Studios (AppLovin) and co-founder of accelerator M-Labs.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual / arcade & sports mobile
- **Location:** Lahore, Pakistan
- **Founded:** 2006
- **Headcount:** ~175 employees
- **Ownership:** Private; funding/ownership unconfirmed
- **Description:** Independent Lahore studio and one of Pakistan's most prominent; known for Whacksy Taxi (topped the App Store in 25+ countries), Cricket Revolution and War Inc.

Flagship titles

Whacksy Taxi

Launch: 2010

Genre: Casual arcade/racing _(older listing; availability may vary by region)_

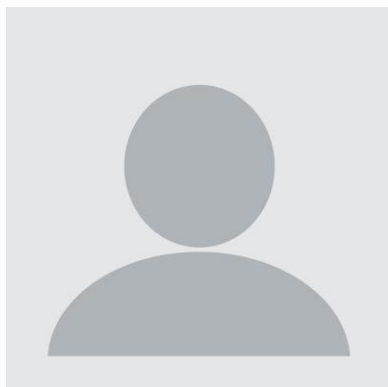
Cricket Revolution

Launch: 2009

Genre: Sports (cricket)

Recent news & activity

- Ahmed serves as head of strategy & technology at AppLovin's Lion Studios, bridging Pakistan's dev scene with global publishing.
- Co-founder/seed backer of M-Labs, a Pakistan game-dev accelerator.
- No InvestGame deal records found for Mindstorm Studios; funding/ownership unconfirmed.



Craig Chittick

[LinkedIn](#)

Director of Corporate Finance, Miniclip

Joined Miniclip in 2021 to lead corporate finance and M&A execution. Brings three decades of dealmaking across media and technology, including Corporate Strategy Director at BGL Group and M&A Director EMEA at Dentsu Aegis

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile & online games publisher
- **Location:** Neuchâtel, Switzerland
- **Founded:** 2001 by Robert Small & Tihan Presbie
- **Headcount:** ~1,260 employees
- **Ownership:** Majority-owned by Tencent (since 2015)
- **Description:** World-leading games company with 10bn+ downloads and 400m+ monthly players across sports, puzzle and casual titles

Flagship titles

8 Ball Pool

Launch: 2012

Genre: Sports / pool

Subway Surfers

Launch: 2012

Genre: Endless runner

Recent news & activity

- Open for M&A to acquire EBITDA positive business
- January 2025, Miniclip acquired Easybrain for \$1.2bn and Lessmore for a total consideration of \$382 million (total consideration)
- In Apr-24 acquired Gamovation for \$100m+
- In Mar-24 acquired Futurlab for a Total Consideration of \$350m



Saad Choudri

Chief Executive Officer, Miniclip

[LinkedIn](#)

Appointed CEO in November 2022 after joining Miniclip in 2011 from Sega. Previously served as Chief Strategy Officer, Chief Commercial Officer and VP of Business Affairs, leading the group's M&A strategy and the acquisitions of Sybo and Easybrain.

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Stephan Ansari

[LinkedIn](#)

Director of Strategic Partnerships, Miniclip

With Miniclip since 2017, leading strategic partnerships after roles as Head of Strategic Partnerships and Commercial Manager. Previously VP Business Development Europe at InMobi, VP Business Development at Yazino, and senior roles at OGPlanet and Glu Mobile

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Dave Yonamine

**Founder & Chairman of the Board,
MobilityWare**

[LinkedIn](#)

Founded MobilityWare in 1990 and served as CEO until 2015, since acting as Chairman of the Board. An ex-systems programmer (Unisys, Burroughs) who built the company's flagship Solitaire franchise.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual card / puzzle mobile
- **Location:** Irvine, CA, United States
- **Founded:** 1990
- **Headcount:** ~220 employees
- **Ownership:** Private (founder-led/independent)
- **Description:** Irvine, CA developer best known for its Solitaire franchise and other casual card/puzzle games; classified by InvestGame as a strategic/CVC investor.

Flagship titles

**Solitaire by
MobilityWare**

Launch: 2008

Genre: Casual card
(solitaire)

Solitaire TriPeaks

Launch: 2014

Genre: Casual card
(solitaire)

Recent news & activity

- \$231M 2025 Revenue and \$78M Adj. EBITDA
- Feb 4, 2025 — MobilityWare participated as a strategic investor in Bigabid's \$25.0M Series A.
- Continues as Chairman of the Board overseeing a founder-led, independent casual-games business.
- Title discrepancy (CEO vs Chairman/Founder) flagged for verification.



Arnd Benninghoff

EVP Gaming, MTG

[LinkedIn](#)

EVP Gaming at MTG since 2014, leading the group's gaming strategy, investments and portfolio (Plarium, Hutch, Ninja Kiwi, PlaySimple). Recently appointed to NODWIN Gaming's board amid its pre-IPO push.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Gaming holding / "gaming village" (mobile + strategy/casual)
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden
- **Founded:** 1987 (group)
- **Headcount:** ~1,000 employees
- **Ownership:** Publicly listed — Nasdaq Stockholm: MTG-B
- **Description:** Listed digital entertainment/gaming group and acquisition platform owning studios incl. Hutch, Ninja Kiwi, PlaySimple, InnoGames and (2024) Plarium; sold ESL Gaming in 2022.

Flagship titles



Recent news & activity

- ~1.3bn 2026E Revenue ~\$316M Adj. EBITDA 2026E Adj. EBITDA
- Mar 2026 — Appointed to NODWIN Gaming's board as the esports firm began pre-IPO fundraising.
- Apr 23, 2026 — MTG filed PlaySimple Games for a ~\$350M IPO in Mumbai.



Nick Hopkins

CFO, MTG

[LinkedIn](#)

MTG Group CFO (announced Feb 2025, joined May 2025), driving strategy, operations and M&A. A 15+ year investment banker (Managing Director at Bank of America; previously 13 years at Goldman Sachs) covering gaming/media/tech.

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Flagship titles



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Sai Srinivas

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO, Mobile Premier League (MPL)

Co-founder of MPL (with Shubham Malhotra, 2018), one of the world's largest mobile esports and skill-gaming platforms with 90M+ users across India, Indonesia and the US and 70+ titles. Earlier a product leader at Zynga and Bharti SoftBank. Aerospace Engineering, IIT Kanpur.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile esports & skill gaming (fantasy, casual, quizzing, esports)
- **Location:** Bengaluru, India
- **Founded:** July 2018
- **Headcount:** ~700+ employees
- **Ownership:** Private; venture-backed
- **Description:** One of the world's largest mobile gaming and esports platforms; 70+ games and 90M+ users across India, Indonesia and the US.

Flagship titles

Fantasy Cricket

Launch: 2019

Genre: Fantasy sports

MPL Rummy

Launch: 2018

Genre: Skill card game

Recent news & activity

- Reached ~\$2.3B valuation within ~3 years of founding, backed by leading global investors.
- 90M+ registered users across India, Indonesia and the US; 70+ games on the platform.
- Continued focus on skill-gaming, esports and supporting India's game-developer ecosystem.



Rohit Sharma

Executive Director, Nazara

[LinkedIn](#)

Whole-time/Executive Director at Nazara (effective Aug 13, 2025; 5-year term) with 25+ years in games and digital media. Founder/former CEO of POKKT Mobile Ads (acquired by AnyMind, where he became Global COO).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Gaming & sports-media platform (diversified)
- **Location:** Mumbai, India
- **Founded:** 1999
- **Headcount:** ~74 at holding-co level (per market data; group much larger via subsidiaries)
- **Ownership:** Publicly listed — NSE/BSE: NAZARA
- **Description:** Listed Indian gaming & sports-media platform spanning gamified learning (Kiddopia), esports/esports media (Nodwin, Sportskeeda), telco subscription and skill-based gaming; owns IPs incl. World Cricket Championship.

Flagship titles

World Cricket Championship 3 (WCC3)

Launch: 2021

Genre: Sports
(cricket) — via Nazara's
Nextwave Multimedia

Kiddopia - Kids Learning Games

Launch: 2019

Genre: Kids
edutainment
(subscription)

Recent news & activity

- Largest M&A to date announced in March 2026: acquisition of controlling stakes in Bluetile and BestPlay for a total \$100.3m
- FY26 revenue grew 13% YoY to \$191.2m,). FY26 EBITDA grew 66% YoY to \$26.7m at a 13.9% margin
- Gaming now contributes 90% of group EBITDA (vs. 56% in FY25), reflecting Nazara's convergence toward a single high-margin global gaming platform across mobile, PC & console, and offline
- Nazara took Sportskeeda parent Curve Games to 100% (\$22m); In 2024 acquired Fusebox Games for \$27.2M.



Alicia Huang

VP, Business Development, Infold

[LinkedIn](#)

Listed as VP, Business Development at Infold Games (the international arm of Papergames, maker of Infinity Nikki). Limited public information: title and background are unconfirmed via public sources.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Open-world / dress-up & otome (premium-feel free-to-play)
- **Location:** Singapore (Infold Pte. Ltd.); Papergames HQ in China (Suzhou); offices in LA, Tokyo, Seoul, Taipei
- **Founded:** Infold international brand launched Aug 2022 (Papergames earlier)
- **Headcount:** ~500–1,000 (LinkedIn band; approx., group-level)
- **Ownership:** Private (Papergames / Infold Pte. Ltd.)
- **Description:** Papergames is the Chinese developer behind the Nikki dress-up franchise and Love and Deepspace; Infold is its international brand. Recent flagship Infinity Nikki is an open-world styling/adventure game built in Unreal Engine.

Flagship titles

Infinity Nikki

Launch: 2024

Genre: Open-world styling/adventure

Love and Deepspace

Launch: 2024

Genre: Otome / romance RPG (package ID not re-verified — confirm before publishing)

Recent news & activity

- Dec 2024 — Infinity Nikki launched globally on Google Play (4M+ downloads in early window), a major multiplatform release.
- May 2024 — Papergames launched Infold as its international brand (LA, Tokyo, Seoul, Taipei).



Janette D'Alessio [LinkedIn](#)
Head of Business Development, Plan A Games

Head of Business Development at Plan A Games, focused on non-dilutive UA funding to help studios scale without giving up equity. Former Big Fish Games executive; earlier BD at mobile-growth firm Lab Cave.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Gaming finance / UA capital & analytics (not a game studio)
- **Location:** United States
- **Founded:** 2025
- **Headcount:** ~10 employees
- **Ownership:** Private / early-stage (InvestGame logs an undisclosed early-stage round, Nov 2025)
- **Description:** US gaming-finance & analytics platform providing non-dilutive user-acquisition capital to free-to-play developers, plus performance-monitoring tools across casual, mid-core and social-casino.

Flagship titles

Plan A Games (UA capital platform)

Game-performance analytics tools

Recent news & activity

- Nov 26, 2025 — Plan A Games recorded an undisclosed early-stage funding round.
- D'Alessio leads BD positioning Plan A as an equity-friendly UA funding partner to studios.



Michael Berkovich

Co-Founder & Co-CEO, Play Perfect

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Play Perfect in 2021 after R&D roles in the IDF's elite 8200 unit and at cybersecurity firm Tufin. MBA, Tel Aviv University.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Skill-based real-cash mobile gaming
- **Location:** Tel Aviv, Israel
- **Founded:** 2021
- **Headcount:** ~100 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held (founder-led)
- **Description:** Play Perfect (PlayPerfect) is a Tel Aviv-based mobile gaming studio building skill-based, real-money competition games that put modern, social twists on classics like Solitaire and Bingo. Founded by gaming-industry veterans, it has surpassed 8M+ downloads across 5 countries.

Main title / product overview

Solitaire Smash

Launch: 2023

Genre: Skill-based cash Solitaire

Bingo Billions

Launch: 2024

Genre: Skill-based cash Bingo

Recent news & activity

- In December, raised \$25M equity at a valuation of \$300M and \$40M of Senior Secured Debt.
- Solitaire Smash ranks among the top card/casino apps on the US iOS App Store, with a 4.8 star rating.



Chen Leshez

[LinkedIn](#)

SVP Corporate Development, Playtika

SVP Corporate Development at Playtika (promoted from VP), co-leading M&A, investments and strategy. Previously an LBO/MBO associate at Apax Partners and a transaction-advisory consultant at EY.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual & social-casino mobile
- **Location:** Herzliya Pituach, Israel
- **Founded:** 2010
- **Headcount:** ~2,800 employees
- **Ownership:** Publicly listed — Nasdaq: PLTK
- **Description:** Listed mobile games company developing free-to-play casual and social-casino titles with strong live-ops; highly acquisitive (SuperPlay, Reworks, Seriously, Wooga).

Flagship titles

Bingo Blitz

Launch: 2010

Genre: Social-casino
(bingo)

Slotomania

Launch: 2011

Genre: Social-casino
(slots)

Recent news & activity

- Jan 2026 — Playtika announced a ~15% workforce reduction, pivoting to fewer/sharper teams and more AI/automation.
- Sep 18, 2024 — Playtika acquired SuperPlay for ~\$2,000.0M, its largest deal — central to Corporate Development.
- 2023 — InnPlay Labs (\$300M) and Azerion/Youda portfolio (~\$164.8M) acquisitions.

Robert Antokol



Robert Antokol CEO, Playtika

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Playtika in 2010 and has been CEO since founding (Chairperson since 2020), growing headcount from <50 to 3,700+. Oversaw the Caesars sale, the 2016 Giant-led consortium sale and the 2021 IPO; title expanded to CEO, President & Chairperson in 2026.

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Brian Lovell

Founder & CEO, Red Games

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of RED GAMES Co. Previously founded RED Interactive Agency, the digital agency of record for brands such as ESPN, Netflix and Disney, acquired by WME in 2016 and fully integrated into 160over90 (Endeavor) in 2019.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Family-friendly / kids mobile games (licensed-IP partnerships + original IP)
- **Location:** Salt Lake, Utah
- **Founded:** 2018
- **Headcount:** ~80
- **Ownership:** Owned by Aonic
- **Description:** RED GAMES Co. is a mobile gaming studio focused on family-friendly games and experiences. It partners with leading toy and entertainment companies like Apple, Hasbro, LEGO, and Crayola, while also developing its own original IP.

Main title / product overview

Crayola Create & Play+
Launch: 2019
Genre: kids' creativity/colouring app

Crayola Scribble Scrubbie+
Launch: 2023
Genre: Kid's colouring app

Recent news & activity

- Recent launches: Launching a series of Crayola Coloring Apps in July 2026 alongside a Hot Wheels coloring game
- Secured IP for a Warrior Cats game that is in development for 2027
- Launched Coloring with Blippi & Friends, a preschool colouring app powered by Crayola, in Sept 2025
- Crayola Adventures won a 2024 Apple Design Award (Inclusivity) plus multiple NYX Game Awards



Anton Volovyk

Co-CEO, Reface

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-CEO of Reface who joined as Chief Business Officer (owning P&L, marketing and monetization), then rose through COO to Co-CEO. Earlier built an investing career, including at Ukrainian PE fund Horizon Capital.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Consumer AI apps (face-swap, photo/video generation, GenAI content)
- **Location:** Kyiv, Ukraine
- **Founded:** 2018
- **Headcount:** 196
- **Ownership:** Privately held; backed by Andreessen Horowitz, and (Dec 2025) PvX Partners
- **Description:** AI mobile apps studio best known for its Reface face-swap app, now running a portfolio of ~6 GenAI products (Reface, Revive, Restyle, unboring.ai) past 300M downloads and expanding into wellbeing and health categories.

Flagship titles

Reface: Face Swap AI Generator

Launch: 2020

Genre: AI photo/video (face swap)

Face Swap AI: Photo Editor

Launch: n/a

Genre: AI photo editor

Recent news & activity

- Raised \$18M in non-dilutive user-acquisition financing led by PvX Partners in late December 2025, directed at marketing and user growth rather than equity.
- Backed by Andreessen Horowitz; portfolio of GenAI apps reportedly ~250–300M downloads.
- Volovyk has discussed Reface's scaling and monetization in Startup Reporter / TechUkraine interviews; has Harvard Business School executive education.



Shlomi Aizenberg

Chief Business Officer, Scopely

[LinkedIn](#)

Scopely's CBO (appointed May 2025) leading acquisition strategy and integration of acquired studios while preserving studio creative independence. Spent over a decade at Playtika, most recently as COO.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Free-to-play mobile (puzzle, strategy, simulation, board); live-ops focused
- **Location:** Los Angeles (Culver City), USA
- **Founded:** 2011
- **Headcount:** ~4000
- **Ownership:** Subsidiary of Savvy Games Group (Saudi PIF); acquired for \$4.9B in 2023
- **Description:** US mobile games publisher/developer specializing in free-to-play live-service titles; now PIF-owned and highly acquisitive.

Flagship titles

MONOPOLY GO!

Launch: 2023

Genre: Board / casual

Stumble Guys

Launch: 2021 (Kitka Games; acquired 2022)

Genre: Battle royale / party

Recent news & activity

- Feb 19, 2026 - Scopely acquired Loom Games (M&A control) for ~\$1B.
- Mar 12, 2025 - Acquired Niantic's games business for ~\$3.5B, plus a \$50.0M investment in Niantic Spatial.
- 2023 - Scopely acquired by Savvy Games Group (PIF) for \$4.9B.
- Aizenberg's May 2025 CBO appointment was covered by Scopely newsroom, VentureBeat and PocketGamer.biz, framing his Playtika M&A track record (Wooga, Seriously, Solitaire Grand Harvest).



Jordi de los Pinos

Founder and CEO, Smadex

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder & CEO of Smadex, with a background in mobile/wireless and performance advertising. Career spans Qualcomm and Telefónica Digital; MBA from MIT Sloan.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** AdTech — mobile demand-side platform (DSP) / programmatic (not a game studio)
- **Location:** Barcelona, Spain
- **Founded:** 2011
- **Headcount:** ~250
- **Ownership:** Acquired by Entravision (NYSE: EVC) in June 2018; part of Entravision's digital/Headway unit
- **Description:** Barcelona-based mobile advertising technology company / DSP using real-time bidding and ML-assisted algorithms to acquire high-value users for app, game and brand advertisers.

Key Clients



Key Partners



Recent news & activity

- In July 2024, Entravision reorganized into two segments — Media and Advertising Technology & Services, making Smadex (with mobile-growth unit Adwake) the core of its new ad-tech segment.
- Owned by Entravision since the June 2018 acquisition; positioned as a mobile-first DSP (CTV, in-app, mobile web).
- In December 2024 Smadex hired ex-Apple Search Ads executive Jamil Downey as VP & GM, Americas to lead its US expansion.



Alexander Ekvall

CEO & Co-founder, Snowprint

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder, CEO and Game Director of Snowprint Studios (founded 2015), with ~15+ years in games. Previously Product Director, Mobile at King, where he worked on Candy Crush Saga.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mid-core mobile strategy / tactical RPG
- **Location:** Stockholm, Sweden (with Berlin office)
- **Founded:** 2015
- **Headcount:** ~70 employees
- **Ownership:** Acquired by Modern Times Group (MTG) in October 2023
- **Description:** Swedish mobile developer specializing in mid-core tactical strategy games, best known for Warhammer 40,000: Tacticus.

Flagship titles

Warhammer 40,000: Tacticus

Launch: 2022

Genre: Turn-based tactical RPG

Legend of Solgard

Launch: 2018

Genre: Puzzle RPG
(legacy King app id; now Snowprint-published)

Recent news & activity

- Oct 5, 2023: Snowprint acquired by MTG (M&A control) (InvestGame).
- Feb 2021: Hiro Capital led a \$15M round across three studios, including Snowprint Studios
- Warhammer 40,000: Tacticus continues as the studio's flagship live-service title.



Queena Qiu

Co-Founder & CEO, Polyverse

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO of NYC-based AI-native studio Polyverse (founded 2022). Previously managed the global launch of Apple Music and Apple's China media rollout, and led international growth at ByteDance/TikTok.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** AI-native entertainment / consumer creative apps (not a traditional game studio)
- **Location:** New York, United States
- **Founded:** 2022
- **Headcount:** 9
- **Ownership:** Private, founder-led; Google for Startups Accelerator graduate
- **Description:** NYC AI-native entertainment studio offering apps that let users edit photos and videos and create images from text via AI. Flagship AI Mirror surpassed 30M downloads in under two years with 1.7B+ images created; companion app Spellai is used by 500K+ creators.

Flagship titles

AI Mirror: AI Photo Editor

Launch: 2022

Genre: Genre: AI photo/avatar app (consumer)

Spellai - AI Art Maker

Launch: 2023

Genre: AI art generator (consumer)

Recent news & activity

- Jan 2026 - Polyverse highlighted accelerating AI-native entertainment with AI Mirror and new creative world-building tools.
- AI Mirror surpassed 30M downloads in under two years; Spellai cited with 500K+ creators.
- Founder featured on ZhenFund's "ZhenCraft: How to build world-class AI products?" panel (Dec 2024).



Gerard Griffin

CFO, Supercell

[LinkedIn](#)

CFO of Supercell, based in Austin, TX, with 25+ years of finance and business leadership across gaming, media and technology. Previously held roles at NBC, EA, Zynga and Sportradar.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile - strategy, action, casual (live-service)
- **Location:** Helsinki, Finland
- **Founded:** 2010
- **Headcount:** ~1000 employees
- **Ownership:** Majority-owned by Tencent (controlling stake acquired 2016)
- **Description:** Finnish mobile developer/publisher built on an autonomous small-team model, behind Clash of Clans, Clash Royale, Brawl Stars, Hay Day and Boom Beach.

Flagship titles

Clash of Clans
Launch: 2012
Genre: Strategy

Brawl Stars
Launch: 2018
Genre: Action / MOBA-shooter

Recent news & activity

- May 5, 2026 - Supercell took M&A control of Metacore (undisclosed), having earlier backed it across multiple rounds (InvestGame).
- Nov 2024 - Series A into Appcharge (\$26.0M) and a full acquisition of Space Ape Games (InvestGame).
- 2022 - Acquired Trailmix (M&A control) with \$60.0M investment
- 2016 - Tencent acquired its controlling stake in Supercell (InvestGame).



Asbjoern Soendergaard CEO & Founder, Tactile

[LinkedIn](#)

Founder, CEO and board member of Tactile Games (founded 2008). Earlier was a Development Manager at Crytek on the Crysis franchise. Following his time at Crytek, he set up the studio as a PC games developer, then pivoted to mobile, launching Lily's Garden in 2019

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile games developer - narrative-driven casual / puzzle (match & blast)
- **Location:** Copenhagen, Denmark
- **Founded:** 2008
- **Headcount:** ~240 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held
- **Description:** Danish mobile developer best known for casual puzzle titles, most notably Lily's Garden.

Flagship titles

Lily's Garden - Design & Relax

Launch: 2019

Genre: Match / merge
puzzle + narrative

Penny & Flo: Home Renovation

Launch: 2020

Genre: Match/puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Banijay Rights and Tactile partnered to launch Simon's Cat Match on mobile (Mar 25, 2025)
- Lily's Garden remains the studio's flagship live-service casual title.
- Soendergaard is an active angel investor and trade-association board member (MAG Interactive, Games Denmark).

Anthony Tirone



Anthony Tirone Founder & CEO, Tech Tree

[LinkedIn](#)

Started building mobile games as a hobby while working as a chemical engineer; went full-time after Idle Planet Miner became a hit. BS Chemical Engineering, University at Buffalo who spent his early career in the industrial-gas sector at Praxair

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Idle, tycoon, management & strategy games
- **Location:** Austin, Texas, USA
- **Founded:** 2018
- **Headcount:** ~40
- **Ownership:** Privately held (founder-led / bootstrapped)
- **Description:** Tech Tree Games is an Austin-based mobile studio making idle, tycoon and strategy games with more depth than the typical mobile title. Its live-ops hits – The Tower, Idle Planet Miner and Zen Idle – hold top-grossing spots in the simulation genre, with ~20M+ lifetime installs

Flagship titles

The Tower

Launch: 2021

Genre: Idle tower defense

Idle Planet Miner

Launch: 2019

Genre: Idle crafting

Recent news & activity

- The Tower - Idle Tower Defense remains a top simulation title, with recent monthly estimates around 70k downloads and ~\$1m revenue, and a Discord community of over 17,000 members (Sensor Tower)
- Operates a portfolio of ~7 live games, with apps appearing in the top 100 in 10+ countries, continuously updated



Carolyn Krenzer

CEO & Founder, Trailmix

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder & CEO of Trailmix (co-founded 2017 with Tristan Clark), recognized among the Top 30 Mobile Gaming Leaders (2025). Before Trailmix she spent ~5 years at King, establishing and leading its London development studio.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile games developer (narrative-driven casual / merge & puzzle)
- **Location:** London, UK (with Berlin presence)
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** ~60 employees
- **Ownership:** Majority-owned by Supercell (acquired a majority stake in 2022); studio retains creative independence
- **Description:** London-based mobile studio focused on casual free-to-play games, best known for the narrative merge puzzle Love & Pies.

Flagship titles

**Love & Pies - Merge
Mystery**

Launch: 2021

Genre: Merge puzzle +
narrative

Recent news & activity

- May 30, 2022 — Supercell acquired a majority stake in Trailmix (M&A control) with \$60.0M investment (InvestGame).
- Krenzer was recognized among the Top 30 Mobile Gaming Leaders (2025).
- She is profiled by Neon River and PocketGamer.biz and has given a Berlin.de interview on building Trailmix.



Lior Shiff

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder and CEO, Tripledot

Co-founder and CEO of Tripledot Studios (founded 2017), who led its 2025 \$800M acquisition of AppLovin's games portfolio. Previously co-founded social-games publisher Product Madness (acquired by Aristocrat in 2012); MBA from Stanford GSB.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile games developer & publisher (casual / puzzle)
- **Location:** London, UK
- **Founded:** 2017
- **Headcount:** ~500
- **Ownership:** Privately held; AppLovin holds ~20% following the 2025 deal; reported valuation ~\$2B
- **Description:** London-founded mobile developer/operator focused on casual puzzle and classic card titles; a top-five independent mobile studio with ~\$2B annual gross revenue and ~25M DAU post-AppLovin.

Flagship titles

Woodoku - Wood Block Puzzle

Launch: 2020

Genre: Block puzzle

Solitaire.com - Classic Cards

Launch: 2018

Genre: Card / solitaire

Recent news & activity

- May 7, 2025 - Tripledot acquired AppLovin's gaming division (M&A control) for \$800.0M (InvestGame deal); structured ~\$400M cash + ~\$400M equity (~20% to AppLovin).
- Shiff called the deal transformational on Bloomberg Daybreak Europe.
- Tripledot is reported to be eyeing an IPO and further M&A post-deal (MobileGamer.biz).
- Earlier funding: \$116.0M Series B (Feb 2022) and \$78.0M Series A (Apr 2021) (InvestGame).



Zaur Bedoev

[LinkedIn](#)

Vice President, Corporate Development and Strategy, Tripledot

Heads Corporate Development at Tripledot and was instrumental in the transformational \$800M acquisition of AppLovin's games portfolio. Also associated with Cambridge.Ventures, led by ex-Jagex figures Mark Gerhard and Riaan Hodgson.

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Erkay Uzun

CEO, Unico

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder & CEO of Unico Studio (founded 2018), with a strong AI/computer-engineering background (PhD, Middle East Technical University). recently co-founded a stealth AI startup (2025).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual mobile - puzzle / brain teasers
- **Location:** Palo Alto, California (offices in Istanbul & Ankara)
- **Founded:** 2018
- **Headcount:** ~120 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held/ bootstrapped
- **Description:** Global mobile puzzle & hybrid-casual studio behind the Brain Test franchise, with 1.6bn+ downloads and 750m web plays across 50+ titles

Flagship titles

**Brain Test: Tricky
Puzzles**

Launch: 2019

Genre: Puzzle / brain
teaser

**Brain Test 4: Tricky
Friends**

Launch: n/a

Genre: Puzzle / brain
teaser

Recent news & activity

- Surpassed 1.6 billion total downloads plus 750 million web game plays (Dec 2025), up from 500 million downloads in April 2022
- The Brain Test franchise has driven 1B+ downloads; Brain Test: Tricky Puzzles alone has 100M+ installs on Google Play.
- CEO Erkay Uzun frames the next phase around managing long-term player ecosystems and live operations rather than one-off releases



Vincent Naiden

Managing Partner, Vizion

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Vizion Games (Vizion Interactive) alongside Anton Yarashuk and Sergey Brui, Also, co-founded Strikerz Inc., the Cyprus-based studio behind the football game UFL. Based in Limassol, Cyprus

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Free-to-play farming / simulation (browser, social, mobile)
- **Location:** Cyprus
- **Founded:** 2007
- **Headcount:** ~700 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held, founder-led
- **Description:** Develops multiplayer games for browser, social networks and mobile, best known for the Klondike farming franchise.

Flagship titles

Klondike
Adventures: Farm
Game
Launch: 2019
Genre: Farm
simulation

Klondike: The Lost
Expedition
Launch: 2014
Genre: Farm
simulation

Recent news & activity

- Aug 23, 2019 — Vizion Games received a late-stage investment (undisclosed) (InvestGame).
- [Slack Apr-25]: Klondike, the game grew 20% in 2024. Close to \$200m net revenue and \$40-50m EBITDA
- Klondike Adventures remains the flagship live-service title (40,000+ new players/day per the studio). Over 115m downloads with 1m DAUs



Martina Gianfreda

Founder and Co-CEO, Whatwapp

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founded Whatwapp in 2013 (with Alessandro Lacroce) and serves as Co-CEO. Holds a Master's in Computer Engineering from Politecnico di Milano; also attended Télécom Paris.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Casual mobile - classic / traditional card & board games
- **Location:** Milan, Italy
- **Founded:** 2013
- **Headcount:** ~54 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held, founder-led
- **Description:** Italy's leading mobile gaming studio, specialising in modern takes on classic and evergreen games (card, board & puzzle), with millions of monthly active players across iOS and Android.

Flagship titles

Scopa - Classic Card Game

Launch: ~2012-2013

Genre: Card (Italian Scopa)

Briscola

Launch: ~2013

Genre: Card (Italian Briscola)

Recent news & activity

- [Slack Aug-25]: ~\$10m Revenue and ~20% EBITDA margin for this year
- Whatwapp Entertainment reports ~31.7M+ installs across its portfolio; Scopa and Briscola each exceed 5M installs.
- Gianfreda has appeared on the Made IT Podcast and is profiled by PocketGamer.biz.



Ben Drury

CEO and Co-Founder, Yoto

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-founder & CEO of Yoto (founded 2015), motivated by reducing children's screen time. Previously co-founded digital music platform 7digital (running it through its 2014 public listing) and worked at dotmusic (acquired by Yahoo).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Consumer audio hardware / kids' content (screen-free audio players) - not a game studio
- **Location:** London, UK
- **Founded:** 2015
- **Headcount:** ~313 employees
- **Ownership:** Privately held (primarily owned by its founders and institutional investors, the Chan Zuckerberg Initiative)
- **Description:** UK consumer company making the Yoto Player and Yoto Mini- screen-free, ad-free audio players for children that play physical content cards.

Flagship titles

Yoto: Music, Stories, Sleep

Launch: ~2017

Genre: Kids' audio companion app (hardware-paired)

Recent news & activity

- Secured a \$15m funding package from HSBC UK's Growth Lending Fund (Oct 2024) to support international growth.
- Yoto's flagship products are the Yoto Player and Yoto Mini, with the companion app managing content and parental controls.
- Drury is an angel investor/board member (Pimoroni, Permutive, Causal AI) and has been profiled in Authority Magazine.



Yaron Leyvand

[LinkedIn](#)

Executive Vice President, Mobile Studios

EVP of Mobile Studios at Zynga, overseeing product/development across 10+ studios (Casual, Puzzle, Social Casino, Action, Mid-core, Sports). Joined Zynga in 2013; previously COO at Optimove leading its games vertical.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Mobile & social games - casual, puzzle, social-casino, mid-core
- **Location:** California, USA
- **Founded:** 2007
- **Headcount:** ~2869 employees
- **Ownership:** Wholly owned label of Take-Two Interactive (NASDAQ: TTWO); acquired 2022 for ~\$12.7B
- **Description:** US developer/publisher of long-running mobile and social franchises in casual and social-casino genres; now a Take-Two label.

Flagship titles

Words With Friends

2

Launch: 2017

Genre: Word / puzzle

Toon Blast

Launch: 2017 (Peak)

Genre: Match / puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Jan 10, 2022 - Zynga acquired by Take-Two Interactive (M&A control) for \$12,700.0M (InvestGame); Take-Two FY2026 revenue ~\$6.66B (InvestGame market data).
- Major franchise-building M&A under Leyvand's product era includes Peak Games (\$2,083.4M, 2020), StarLark (\$525M, 2021) and Chartboost (\$250M, 2021) (InvestGame).
- Leyvand's remit spans Words With Friends, Zynga Poker, Empires & Puzzles, Toon Blast and Merge Dragons!, plus licensed IP (Harry Potter, Game of Thrones).



H O R I Z O N S

Investors



Florian Schuhbauer

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-CIO & Founding Partner, Active Ownership Capital

Founded Active Ownership Capital in 2014 after building the public-equity practice at Triton Partners; earlier CFO of DHL Global Mail US.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Activist / engaged value investor in listed European small & mid-caps (gaming exposure via Aonic + MTG)
- **Location:** Grevenmacher, Luxembourg (offices Frankfurt, Vienna, Stockholm)
- **Founded:** 2014 — Florian Schuhbauer & Klaus Röhrig
- **Headcount:** ~5
- **Ownership:** Independent, LP-backed closed-end fund (Active Ownership Fund SCS)
- **Description:** Activist minority investor applying a PE value-creation playbook to European listed companies.

Recent investments

Aonic Group

Invested: 2024

Genre: Mobile gaming
& ad-tech

Prime Insights

Invested: 2025

Genre: Data /
research-tech

Recent news & activity

- Re-elected to MTG (Modern Times Group) board, May 2026 AGM
- Aonic acquired Prime Insights for >\$250M (Sep 2025)
- Elected to HelloFresh supervisory board; AOC ~7.7% holder (Apr/May 2025)
- Aonic €152M growth round closed (Dec 2024)



Akin Babayigit

[LinkedIn](#)

Managing Director & Founder, Arcadia Gaming Partners

Co-founded and led Tripledot Studios (London, ~\$1.4B valuation) as President for 7+ years; earlier scaled Peak Games (sold to Zynga for \$1.8B) with roles at Google, Meta and Activision Blizzard King.

Company Overview

- Genre:** Mobile games VC (casual, puzzle, hybrid-casual) + gaming AI/tech; early-to-growth stage
- Location:** London, UK
- Founded:** 2024 – Akin Babayigit (with Orkun Kılıç)
- Headcount:** ~3 (Babayigit, Kılıç, Principal Sabahat Gümüştas)
- Ownership:** Independent; \$100M Fund I (LLP)
- Description:** Founder-led \$100M fund backing mobile-game studios and gaming-tech, concentrated in Turkish & UK founders.

Recent investments

TaleMonster Games

Invested: 2026

Genre: Casual match-3
· Series A \$30M

Loom Games

Invested: 2025

Genre: Casual

Recent news & activity

- Launched AMF Capital, a UA-financing JV with Makers Fund — first deal \$28M for Bear Hug (Jun 2026)
- Backed Iron Games (\$4M, Nov 2025) and Sett AI (\$27M, May 2025)
- \$100M fund launch broken by Bloomberg (Mar 2025)
- Podcasts/panels: EU.VC (Mar 2025), Mobidictum “billion-dollar blueprint” (Oct 2025), 2.5 Gamers (Mar 2026)



Chris Lee
Co-Founder, Cascade Interactive

[LinkedIn](#)

25+ year game-dev veteran who co-founded Cascade Interactive, with VP roles at EA and Activision; active angel/advisor to Hello Games, Triplicated, Hutch, Space Ape and Omeda Studios.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Video game publisher — extreme/action sports (PC, console, mobile)
- **Location:** Canterbury / London, UK
- **Founded:** 2024 — Chris Lee, Matt Jones, Jono Jones, Rod Drury (Xero founder)
- **Headcount:** ~10
- **Ownership:** Private Ltd, founder-financed (no fund/AUM)
- **Description:** Athlete-led publisher of AAA extreme-sports games; debut title MAVRIX.

Recent investments

MAVRIX (Early Access)

Launch: Jul 2025
Genre: Open-world MTB

MAVRIX (Console)

Launch: Jan 2026
Genre: PS5 / Xbox launch

Recent news & activity

- MAVRIX Steam/Epic Early Access (Jul 2025)
- MAVRIX console launch on PS5/Xbox (Jan 2026)
- Third Kind Games dev partnership announced (Apr 2025)



Başak Bükümcü

Principal, e2vc

[LinkedIn](#)

Principal at e2vc focused on sourcing, diligence and portfolio support for Turkey/CEE founders; previously an investor at Istanbul-based ScaleX Ventures.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Early-stage (pre-seed/seed) tech VC; gaming is a lead vertical (plus AI, devtools, fintech)
- **Location:** Amsterdam HQ (Istanbul, SF, NY, London)
- **Founded:** 2016 as 500 Emerging Europe; rebranded to e2vc Nov 2024 — GPs Enis Hülli & Arın Özkula
- **Headcount:** ~12
- **Ownership:** Independent LP-backed; €100M Fund III (first close Jan 2026); ~€180M+ across funds
- **Description:** Early-stage VC backing globally ambitious founders from Türkiye & Emerging Europe (4 unicorns incl. fal.ai).

Recent investments

Loom Games

Invested: 2026

Genre: Mobile hybrid-casual · Seed \$2M

Cypher Games

Invested: 2025

Genre: Mobile match-3 · Series A \$30M

Recent news & activity

- Fund III €100M first close (Jan 2026)
- 500 startups → e2vc rebrand (Nov 2024)
- Loom Games → Scopely \$1B exit (Feb 2026)
- ITKeyMedia Fund III interview with Başak (Feb 2026)



Marc Allera

[LinkedIn](#)

Chair, Global Sport Group; Chairman, Jagex

Former CEO of EE and of BT's Consumer division (2016–Mar 2025), where he led the UK's 5G rollout; earlier UK GM of Sega, launching the Dreamcast.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** CVC sports-investment platform aggregating premium sports rights & media
- **Location:** Luxembourg
- **Founded:** 2025 — backed by CVC Capital Partners
- **Headcount:** ~5
- **Ownership:** CVC-controlled; ~€7B valuation (~€3.7B financing from KKR/PIMCO)
- **Description:** Aggregates premium sports assets — La Liga, Ligue 1, WTA, Six Nations and others. Marc Allera also chairs Jagex (RuneScape).

Recent investments

Jagex

Deal: 2024 · ~\$1.1B

Genre: PC/console
MMORPG

Equine Network

Deal: 2026 · ~\$300M

Genre: Sports media

Recent news & activity

- Appointed Global Sport Group Chair (Jun 2025)
- Stepped down as BT/EE CEO (Mar 2025)
- GSG ~€3.7B financing from KKR/PIMCO (Mar 2026)
- SportsPro feature + StreamTime podcast (2026)



Alex Capretta

[LinkedIn](#)

Managing Director, Haveli Investments

MD at Haveli Investments focused on tech/gaming; previously at Vista Equity Partners, C3 AI and Credit Suisse, and in Brian Sheth's family office. Wharton MBA, Princeton BA.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Tech-focused PE - enterprise software buyouts + a dedicated gaming VC strategy (PC, mobile, console)
- **Location:** Austin, Texas
- **Founded:** 2021 - Brian Sheth (Vista co-founder)
- **Headcount:** ~55
- **Ownership:** Independent, LP-backed (Apollo partnership); Software Fund I \$4.5B + Gaming VC Fund I ~\$834M; ~\$5.3B+ AUM
- **Description:** Austin tech investor running the largest-ever debut software buyout fund alongside a dedicated gaming venture fund.

Recent investments

Budge Studios

Invested: 2026

Genre: Children's mobile games · M&A

Jagex

Invested: 2024 · ~\$1.1B

Genre: PC/console MMORPG (w/ CVC)

Recent news & activity

- Budge Studios acquisition from General Atlantic (Feb 2026)
- Software Fund I closed at \$4.5B (2025)
- Acquired Private Division from Take-Two → relaunched as Fictions (2024–25)
- Million Victories \$40M (2025)



Melisa Yaguboglu

Principal, Laton Ventures

[LinkedIn](#)

Principal at Laton Ventures focused on operational support for portfolio gaming startups. Previously an associate at Aream & Co.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Gaming VC
- **Location:** Turkey
- **Founded:** 2023
- **Headcount:** Small fund team (founder Gökem Türk, plus Volkan Özen, Sinem Zeynep Anıl)
- **Ownership:** Türkiye-backed VC; LPs include 40+ exited founders and strategics (e.g., Supercell). First fund ~\$50M.
- **Description:** Gaming-focused VC investing at pre-seed and seed in gaming and gaming-adjacent startups globally, with operational support across game design, UA, analytics, and marketing.

Recent investments

Grand Games

Invested: 2026 · \$70M

Genre: Mobile gaming

Born

Invested: 2025 · \$15M

Genre: AI gaming tech

Recent news & activity

- Active investor: 2026-05-11 — Grand Games Series B \$70.0M; 2026-03-03 — Antihero Studios Seed \$4.5M; 2025-09-10 — Born Series A \$15.0M (Laton as investor, per InvestGame).
- Backed by Supercell and 40+ exited founders; first fund closed at ~\$50M (per GamesBeat).



Jay Chi

[LinkedIn](#)

Founding Partner, Makers Fund

Co-founded Makers Fund after leading McKinsey's global video-games practice (2006–2017); also a Founding Partner of indie-dev fund Kowloon Nights. Stanford.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Global gaming & interactive-entertainment VC; seed–Series B (content, tools/tech, platforms)
- **Location:** San Francisco (LA, NY, London, Tokyo, Singapore, Reykjavik)
- **Founded:** 2016 — Jay Chi & Michael Cheung
- **Headcount:** ~30
- **Ownership:** Independent, LP-backed (endowments/foundations); 3 funds, \$1B+ AUM (Fund III \$500M, 2022)
- **Description:** Dedicated global VC for early-stage games and interactive-entertainment companies.

Recent investments

General Intuition

Invested: 2025 ·
\$134M

Genre: Gaming AI /
spatial reasoning

Human Computer

Invested: 2025 ·
\$5.7M

Genre: Story-driven
games studio

Recent news & activity

- Co-launched AMF Capital UA-financing JV with Arcadia / Akin Babayigit (Jun 2026)
- General Intuition \$134M seed (Oct 2025)
- Portfolio co Dream Games valued ~\$5B (2025)
- Midnite Series C \$35M (Jan 2026)



Henric Suuronen

[LinkedIn](#)

Founding Partner, Play Ventures

Co-founded Play Ventures in 2018 after co-founding Nonstop Games (sold to King for up to \$100M); earlier Head of Studio at Wooga and an active angel (Huuuge Games, Astralis).

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Early-stage gaming VC — mobile F2P, studios, gaming infrastructure/B2B, AI tools, + a Web3 sub-fund
- **Location:** Singapore + Helsinki
- **Founded:** 2018 — Henric Suuronen & Harri Manninen
- **Headcount:** ~20
- **Ownership:** Independent, LP-backed (LPs incl. Supercell, Rovio, MTG); ~\$450M AUM (Fund III \$140M, Nov 2024)
- **Description:** Leading early-stage VC dedicated to gaming, founded by gaming entrepreneurs, investing pre-seed–Series A globally.

Recent investments

Appcharge

Invested: 2025 · \$58M

Genre: D2C mobile-game payments · Series B

Cypher Games

Invested: 2025 · \$30M

Genre: Mobile match-3 · Series A

Recent news & activity

- Fund III closed at \$140M, ~\$450M AUM (Nov 2024)
- Portfolio co INCRMNTAL acquired by Smartly (May 2026)
- Backed PvX Partners (Ridzki's firm) across seed → Series A
- DealMakers podcast with Henric (Oct 2025)



Paul Wharshavsky

Co-Founder and CEO

[LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & CEO of POW! Interactive, also announced as Co-President of UVS Games (alongside Luohan Wei). Previously a Venture Partner at Lalotte Ventures, with ~13 years growing consumer/IP brands.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Holding company / investor-operator in gaming, fandom & interactive entertainment
- **Location:** New York, NY (US)
- **Founded:** 2021
- **Headcount:** ~50
- **Ownership:** Privately held
- **Description:** Holding company that invests in, acquires, and operates businesses across gaming and interactive entertainment. Its anchor holding is UVS Games, publisher of the UniVersus collectible card game (IPs include My Hero Academia and TEKKEN 8) and Riftbound.

Recent investments

Jasco Games

Invested: 2021

Genre: Tabletop / hobby games publisher (CCGs, board games & figurines)

Voldex

Invested: 2022

Genre: UGC games developer on Roblox

Recent news & activity

- UVS Games (ex-Jasco) named English & global publisher of Riot's Riftbound: League of Legends TCG (Feb 2025)
- Riftbound English launch (Origins set) Oct 31, 2025; next set Spiritforged out Feb 13, 2026
- Portfolio co Voldex acquired Brookhaven, Roblox's most-visited game, becoming the #1 Roblox developer by audience (Feb 2025)
- Jasco Games rebranded as UVS Games post-acquisition; launched the multi-IP Challenger Series CCG line



Yuning Zhang

[LinkedIn](#)

Vice President, TPG / Integrated Media Company

VP at Integrated Media Company, the TPG-backed group behind Fandom, GameSpot and Metacritic. Works on investments and media/gaming brand strategy, including IMC's acquisition of Balatro publisher Playstack.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Media & entertainment investment / brand holding
- **Location:** USA
- **Founded:** Integrated Media Company — backed by TPG
- **Headcount:** ~5
- **Ownership:** Owned by private-equity firm TPG
- **Description:** Owns and operates Fandom, GameSpot, Metacritic & Fanatical; acquiring indie publisher Playstack (Balatro)

Flagship titles

Fandom

Type: Media / wiki platform

GameSpot

Type: Games media

Recent news & activity

- IMC (TPG's digital-media platform; owns Fandom, GameSpot, Fanatical) agreed to acquire Balatro publisher Playstack (~£112M / ~\$151M) - its first major move into game publishing (May 2026).
- Made an \$85M late-stage investment in 'Twelve' (per InvestGame deal data) (Apr 2025).
- Yuning Zhang is a TPG VP / IMC team member who led IMC's Toon Boom Animation acquisition.



Ridzki Syahputera [LinkedIn](#)

Co-Founder & Chief Revenue Officer, PvX Partners

Co-founded PvX Partners in 2024; previously in corporate development at Mobile Premier League (MPL) and an investor at Convergence Ventures, with earlier roles at RTB House, Ogilvy and PwC.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Non-dilutive UA / cohort financing for mobile games & consumer apps (+ ROAS analytics)
- **Location:** Singapore
- **Founded:** 2024 — Joe Wadakethalakal (CEO), Ridzki Syahputera (CRO), Zhen Jie Sim (CCO)
- **Headcount:** ~20
- **Ownership:** Independent; balance sheet via General Catalyst CVF; backers incl. Play Ventures, Z Venture Capital, Square Enix; ~\$19M equity, \$750M+ UA committed
- **Description:** Gaming fintech providing performance-based, non-dilutive UA financing to studios.

Recent investments

Midnite

Financed: 2025 · \$100M

Genre: Gaming ecosystem · UA financing

Smash Games

Financed: 2026 · \$2M
Genre: Hybrid-casual · UA financing

Recent news & activity

- Series A \$10.5M led by T-Accelerate, \$750M+ committed (Apr 2026)
- Seed extension \$4.7M, \$250M milestone (Dec 2025)
- \$3.8M seed co-led by Play Ventures & General Catalyst (Mar 2025)
- The Gaming Playbook podcast (Jul 2025)

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H O R I Z O N S

Other



Rudi Bonaparte

[LinkedIn](#)

VP, Head of Strategy, LEGO Digital Play

Corporate strategy and operations leader with 20+ years' experience, now Head of Strategy at LEGO Digital Play. Spent nearly 12 years at Riot Games, including seven as Director of Corporate Strategy & Business Operations. AB, Harvard.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Digital games & interactive play (LEGO brand)
- **Location:** Billund, Denmark (LEGO Group); global team
- **Founded:** 2025 (new venture); LEGO Group founded 1932
- **Headcount:** Growing venture led by industry veterans
- **Ownership:** Part of the LEGO Group / KIRKBI (privately, family-owned)
- **Description:** LEGO's dedicated digital-play venture, led by Aaron Loeb, building original interactive experiences for the brand

Flagship titles

LEGO Digital Play

Launch: 2025

Genre: New digital-play venture

Recent news & activity

- A new entity created by LEGO Holding (KIRKBI) to explore original branded gaming experiences, operating independently of the LEGO Group (Jun 2025).
- Early-stage and hiring; no titles announced yet.
- Interview with [Deconstructor of Fun](#) looking at the future of the business ([link](#))



Marcus Liassides

[LinkedIn](#)

SVP & Global Head of Digital, Mattel

Leads Mattel's global digital strategy across Licensing, Mattel Future Lab and self-publishing, championing 'playable IP' that brings brands like Barbie and Hot Wheels into games and creator platforms. 20+ years in digital media.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Toys & entertainment; games via licensing & self-publishing
- **Location:** El Segundo, California, USA
- **Founded:** 1945
- **Headcount:** Global company (~30,000 employees)
- **Ownership:** Public (NASDAQ: MAT)
- **Description:** Maker of Barbie, Hot Wheels, UNO & more; expanding iconic IP into games and creator platforms like Roblox

Flagship titles

Hot Wheels Unleashed

Launch: 2021

Genre: Arcade racing
(Milestone)

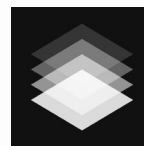
Barbie Dreamhouse

Launch: 2023

Genre: Roblox IP
experience

Recent news & activity

- Agreed to buy out NetEase's 50% stake in mobile studio Mattel163 (UNO!, Phase 10) for \$159M, taking full ownership (550M+ downloads, ~20M MAU) (Feb 2026).
- Building a three-pillar digital strategy: licensing (Take-Two, Xbox, Supercell, Netflix), self-publishing (first original mobile titles due 2026), and creator platforms (Roblox, Fortnite).



Emmanuel de Maistre

Co-Founder & CEO, Scenario

[LinkedIn](#)

Serial deep-tech entrepreneur who co-founded Scenario in 2021 to bring generative AI to game art. Previously founded Redbird (drone analytics, acquired by Airware) and co-founded the biotech Alderys. Paris-born, now based in San Francisco.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Generative-AI tooling for game art & asset creation
- **Location:** San Francisco, USA
- **Founded:** 2021 by Emmanuel de Maistre & Hervé Nivon
- **Headcount:** ~20 employees
- **Ownership:** Private; \$6M seed (Play Ventures and others)
- **Description:** Platform that lets studios train custom AI models to generate style-consistent game assets via web and API

Flagship titles

Scenario GenAI Engine

Launch: 2023

Genre: Custom AI asset generation

Scenario API

Launch: 2023

Genre: Asset-generation API

Recent news & activity

- Raised a \$6M seed (Play Ventures, Anorak Ventures, angels incl. Brendan Iribe, Justin Kan); total funding reported ~\$10.9M.
- AI platform for generating game art/assets; expanded into 3D mesh generation (FBX/Obj/gltf) with native Unity/Unreal integration, positioning itself as 'creative AI infrastructure.'



Nathan Jones
Head of Corporate Strategy & Development

[LinkedIn](#)

VP of Corporate Strategy & Development at Sony Interactive Entertainment with 5+ years driving M&A and strategic initiatives in gaming. Previously spent 9 years at WB Games co-founding their mobile publishing business

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Console hardware, first-party games & interactive entertainment
- **Location:** Sony Interactive Entertainment — San Mateo, USA & Tokyo, Japan
- **Founded:** 1993 (Sony Interactive Entertainment)
- **Headcount:** Global; thousands of employees
- **Ownership:** Subsidiary of Sony Group (TYO: 6758)
- **Description:** Maker of the PlayStation platform and first-party studios (Naughty Dog, Insomniac, Santa Monica and more)

Flagship titles

PlayStation 5
Launch: 2020
Genre: Game console platform

Recent news & activity

- Latest acquisition: full control of Cinemersive Labs (Apr 2026)
- Recent bets are strategic stakes - ~\$464M in Bandai Namco, ~\$318.5M in Kadokawa
- Owns PlayStation Studios via past buyouts - Bungie (~\$3.7B), Insomniac, Bluepoint; ~\$2.5B in Epic Games
- Sony Innovation Fund backs AI IP-protection startup Midnight Labs (Jun 2026)
- Q4 FY2025: record annual profit, but net income -63%; FY2026 guide +11% op profit, ¥500B buyback



Maya Rogers

President & CEO, Tetris

[LinkedIn](#)

President & CEO of Tetris, leading the brand's global business since 2007 and as CEO since 2014. Daughter of Henk Rogers, who secured the Tetris rights. Co-founder of Hawaii accelerator Blue Startups; ex-Sony and Honda.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** Puzzle game IP, licensing & brand management
- **Location:** USA
- **Founded:** Blue Planet Software 1995; rolled into The Tetris Company 2020
- **Headcount:** Lean brand-management team (~10)
- **Ownership:** Privately held (Tetris Holding)
- **Description:** Manages worldwide licensing and development of Tetris, one of the best-selling game franchises of all time

Flagship titles

Tetris
Launch: 1984
Genre: Puzzle

Tetris Effect
Launch: 2018
Genre: Puzzle

Recent news & activity

- Partnered with Red Bull for a global Tetris esports series, culminating in a World Final at the Dubai Frame (2,000+ drones rendering a playable Tetris in the sky) (Dec 2025).
- Tetris Forever (a Digital Eclipse compilation + interactive documentary) released Nov 2024.
- Continued 40th-anniversary brand/licensing expansion (PUMA, H&M, Uniqlo apparel; IMG as licensing agent).



Bernard Kim

[LinkedIn](#)

Advisor & Board Member (Unity independent director)

Gaming and technology veteran (20+ years) appointed an independent director to Unity's Board effective May 1, 2026. Former CEO of Match Group, ex-President of Publishing at Zynga and ex-SVP of Mobile Publishing at Electronic Arts. Also on the Lightspeed advisory council.

Company Overview

- **Genre:** N/A — individual advisor/board member (not a company)
- **Location:** USA
- **Description:** Independent board director at Unity Technologies (effective May 1, 2026); previously Match Group CEO (2022 to Feb 2025) and a senior mobile-games publishing executive at Zynga and EA.
- **Business Overview:** Unity [NYSE: U] offers a suite of tools to create, market, and grow games and interactive experiences across all major platforms from mobile, PC, and console, to extended reality.

Flagship product

Unity Platform

Recent news & activity

- Feb 10, 2026 - Unity appointed Kim to its Board of Directors, effective May 1, 2026, alongside the departures of David Helgason and Tomer Bar-Zeev.
- Feb 4, 2025 - Stepped down as Match Group CEO and from its board; Spencer Rascoff succeeded him.
- Earlier career: President of Publishing at Zynga and SVP of Mobile Publishing at EA.

